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[00:13:19] bed meeting. We appreciate how quiet the room got even a couple minutes in advance of the meeting and we're certainly appreciative of you know the attendance here. I will say also as Ms. Atkinson was explaining this is perhaps the board's favorite board meeting of the year having the teachers with us to be recognized so we thank everybody for coming and we look forward to a good morning.

[00:13:46] But first, we're going to rise to a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance. Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:14:24] Okay, I hope all members of the board have had an opportunity to read and review the minutes of the November 13 and 14 meetings of the board. If so, is there a motion to adopt them as drafted, or any proposed changes?

[00:14:43] I move to adopt the amendments from November. Thank you. Dr. Duran, is there a second? Dr. Wilson, thank you. All those in favor, signify by saying aye. Aye. Any opposed? No abstentions. That carries. Okay. One abstention.

[00:14:58] Oh, I'm sorry. One abstention. I didn't see that. All right. Ms. Davis-Vaught, you're on. It should be noted that Ms. Davis-Vaught is the Bristolian of the Year. thank you president gecker dr lane colleagues

on the board welcome to this january session i'm very proud to stand before you today and share this wonderful news with everyone today it is my

[00:15:33] pleasure to recognize eight very special people virginia's teacher of the year and regional teachers of the year for 2020 and recognizing each of these individuals today we are confirming the excellence in education that their peers, co-workers, and students see from them on a daily basis.

[00:15:54] Their enthusiasm for education and their excitement for sharing their knowledge are evident not only in their classrooms but in all aspects of their lives. Their commitment and passion for what they teach is a shining example of the difference a teacher can make in the lives of students each day. I would like to thank Ms. Patty Pitts, Mrs. Tara McDaniel, and the entire teacher education team for their hard work to make Virginia's Teacher of the Year program such a success. We are honored to have with us today these outstanding teachers. I joined the Board of Education in thanking them for their

[00:16:30] hard work, generosity of heart and mind, and for their devotion to Virginia's children and youth. At this time I would like to invite up Mr. Gregory Leindacher to the podium. Mr. Leindacher represents region number one. He is the region number one Virginia Teacher of the Year, an advanced placement and international baccalaureate psychology teacher of students in grades 10, 11, and 12 in Henrico Public Schools.

[00:17:01] He is currently in his 14th year as a teacher and his seventh year at Henrico High School. Mr. Leindacher is involved in many civic and community initiatives. He has participated in the community canned food drive for all food pantries, community winter clothing drive for students at his school, and the community yard sale to raise funds for the American Foundation for Suicide Prevention.

[00:17:25] Mr. Leimdacher's guest today is his principal, Mrs. Karen Castillo-Rose. There's no need to hold the applause to the end. May I please call Ms. Rachel Thompson to the front podium?

[00:17:51] Congratulations. Hi, thank you. I love your enthusiasm. Rachel Thompson, an international baccalaureate, world language Spanish, an advanced placement teacher at Princess Anne High School in Virginia Beach City Public Schools, is the Region II Virginia Teacher of the Year.

[00:18:09] Her 15 years of teaching experience has been in Virginia Beach. In 2004, she earned a Bachelor of Arts from St. Louis University in Madrid, Spain, graduating as valedictorian. While she was completing her bachelor's degree in Spain, the multicultural faculty and students at Mrs. Thompson's University opened her eyes new languages cultures and traditions and sparked a passion for inclusivity diversity intercultural understanding that inform her teaching practices today her guest here today is Ms. Shawna remain assistant principal of

[00:18:45] princess and I hope I didn't butcher that last name I apologize what what how do I say? Shea Ramian. Ramian. So let's give her one more round of applause. I would like to call Latasha Lee to the podium. Thank you. Mrs. Lee is a 17-year veteran from Region 3 Virginia Teacher of the Year. She teaches choral music at Northumberland Middle and High Schools. She has

[00:19:22] been in her current position in Northumberland County Public Schools since 2013. Mrs. Lee is a a native of Northumberland County and is extremely active in her school and community. Mrs. Lee has been involved with the Back to Schools Rally planning team since its inception and became the first African-American woman selected to the Rappahannock Concert Association. She has also received the Women Making a Difference Community Award in 2018. She is a member of Delta Sigma Theta sorority

and her interests include reading, cooking, creating crafts, and and spending time with her husband and son. Joining Mrs. Lee today is her mother, Carolyn Crockett.

[00:20:04] I would like to invite Ms. Sarah Deal to the front. Sarah Deal is a science teacher at Marion Senior High School in Smith County Public Schools. She is the Region 7 Teacher of the Year.

[00:20:31] She teaches biology, anatomy, zoology, and earth science. She is beginning her sixth year as a teacher mrs. deal says her overall goal is to is that each of my students truly knows that i care about them excuse me as individuals i want to be an inspiration to them and instill a love for science and for learning to meet that goal she works beyond the classroom to improve the overall school culture in 2016 she started the science club at marion senior high school ms deal also works with the upward bound program in withville an education program that works with high school students to develop skills

[00:21:07] to be successful in college and careers. Her guest with her here today is Deutie McIntyre. I'd like to invite Michelle Howell to the podium. The Region 8 Virginia Teacher of the Year is Michelle Howell, a teacher of special education at La Crosse Elementary School in Mecklenburg County Public Schools. A 10-year teaching veteran, she's beginning her fourth year in her current

[00:21:43] position. Ms. Howell serves as a mentor to new teachers within the school division and in the the past several years she has affiliated with families embracing autism together. As a FEAT board member she has seen the impact on students when connections transcend the classroom. Mrs. Howell believes that all students can learn with the right educational circumstances. She has high expectations for her students and she celebrates all of their accomplishments. Joining Mrs.

[00:22:11] Howell today is the superintendent Mr. Paul Nichols. Before I introduce our 2020 Virginia Teacher of the Year, I want to acknowledge the Region 4 Teacher of the Year, Jennifer Rogers from Loudoun County, and Region 5 Teacher of the Year, Amy Mallow from Bedford County. Unfortunately, they could not be here with us today due to prior commitments. Now, for our 2020 Virginia Teacher of the Year, Andrea Carson-Johnson, please come to the front.

[00:22:48] She is a representative from Region 6 and she is the Virginia 2020 Teacher of the Year. Mrs. Johnson teaches 12th grade English and English 12 college preparatory classes at Salem High School and Salem City Public Schools. She earned a Bachelor of Arts in 2001 from the University of Virginia. She completed a Master's of Science degree in 2002 from Virginia Commonwealth. In 2012, she completed the Educate Virginia Career Switcher Program through the Virginia Community College system. She obtained an Advanced Placement

[00:23:24] Language and Composition Certificate in 2013 and she is currently pursuing a National Board Certification. Ms. Johnson has 12 years of teaching experience and she is beginning her sixth year in Salem City. Ms. Johnson began her career in education working at Virginia Tech and Virginia Cooperative Extension as a faculty member at the Airfield 4-H Educational Center.

[00:23:53] During that time she learned the importance of backward lesson planning design, the impact of experiential hands-on education, and the power of project-based learning. As a 4-H educator, she co-authored several curricula on outdoor education and team leadership. She was recognized for Environmental Education Program excellence, excellence.

[00:24:15] When her family began to grow, Ms. Johnson felt the calling to be a teacher in a traditional classroom. Remembering the profound impact that her advanced placement English teacher had on her,

she completed the Virginia Career Switcher Program to become a licensed English teacher.

[00:24:33] Salem High School's assistant principal Bridget Nielsen stated, Ms. Johnson has a way of getting the best out of others. Her students want to learn from the first moment they come into her room, and she inspires them to take their skills and knowledge to the next level each day. But the impact of her presence at Salem High School reaches far beyond the students she teaches in her classroom.

[00:24:55] Ms. Johnson's guest today is her husband, Jeremy Johnson. So at this time, Ms. Andrea, come on up for your comments.

[00:25:25] Good morning. I am Andrea Johnson, a 12th grade English teacher at Salem High School and Salem City Schools. It is such an honor to be here representing my school, my division, students across Virginia, and the thousands of selfless, giving, and expert teachers across the state.

[00:25:43] We are just eight of thousands. I am proud to represent the eight 2020 Regional Teachers of the Year. Teaching is truly a noble profession and one that we've been called to do in our lives for bettering the lives of our children.

[00:26:03] As I've been meeting with teachers across the state as Teacher of the Year, I've been sharing with them that they must be well equipped to meet the demands of the classroom and to love our students fiercely. Teaching is too complicated to perfect everything, and we would tell you that, we are not perfect.

[00:26:20] But I do charge teachers with finding their purpose in the classroom. What will be their passion in the classroom? What are they truly going to teach children as we are growing them into humans? I ask teachers to pursue that passion with the utmost confidence that they are changing students' lives because they are, we are, in fact, doing that very thing.

[00:26:46] It is humbling and inspiring to be the face, the teacher that is leading all the other teachers this year, and I'm working my best to do the very best that I can do. My job, I think, this year is to lead our students and our teachers with courage, compassion, and connection, because that is the core of what we do every day.

[00:27:10] So thank you for this opportunity. Those are beautiful statements. Thank you. Congratulations to Andrea Johnson and to each of our Regional Teachers of the Year.

[00:27:29] Thank you for all you do to make our Commonwealth's future bright. Thank you very much. One more last time, and then we will have quick share speech. Thank you.

[00:27:43] All right. You look great. One, two, three. All right. I got a few.

[00:28:45] Thank you.

[00:29:15] okay we're going to move into our public comment period uh each speaker will have three minutes it is the practice of this board not to respond to individual speakers however we do have uh

[00:29:55] staff follow-up you know for all speakers so uh first on the list is uh danielle sephora i apologize if i don't quite get the accents correctly on the name and i understand you're with vsca yes uh i will tell you last night at dinner um the board meets for you know the night before this meeting because we had a meeting yesterday uh some members who have attended your annual convention were speaking just so highly of the competence and you know what a great

[00:30:33] experience it was for board members our board members to be with y'all so thank you for being here today thank you good morning president gecker vice president axon members of the board and state superintendent lane my name is daniela saforo my school cd hilton high school in the prince william Prince William County School Division is the 2019-2020 President School of the Virginia Student Counselors Association. During our school's term as president, I chair a committee on the VSCA that analyzes issues affecting students and teachers. Some of the main concerns that we have and want

[00:31:09] to express to you this morning includes SAT prep, mental health awareness in schools, and standardized testing. I remember as we talked about SAT or ACT prep, a student from Woodgrove High School in the Loudoun County School Division said, the last time I had a gym, I had a gym teacher for SAT prep class. Everyone burst out in laughter, but then many students, including myself, claimed that my school did not even offer any SAT prep course. It is no surprise that wealth is strongly correlated with outcomes on standardized tests. Richer families can afford tutoring, test prep, and

[00:31:43] other activities. As a low-income student myself, I recall searching test prep companies and seeing the prices that I couldn't afford. I resulted to the free Khan Academy prep course. However, it was quite difficult watching videos and not being able to ask a teacher about something that I couldn't comprehend. In order to combat such inequality, institutional leaders should level the playing field by providing disenfranchised people with opportunities and resources such as free ACT, SAT prep classes in their schools. This is why I'm here today. It is my understanding that the vision of the State Board of Education is to ensure equity of opportunity while improving

[00:32:23] student achievement. I believe in order to strive towards such a vision, we must begin to encourage SAT prep courses for each school in their respective districts or even implement curriculum changes that aid in SAT ACT prep. Students can't pick their incomes, but policy can give students a better chance at better scores instead of a select few. Thank you for the opportunity to speak with you today thank you for being with us today and we'll say the board's primary goal right now is equity of outcome for students and your remarks

[00:32:54] were very well taken so thank you okay Ashley Levins good morning President Gecker vice president Atkinson members of the board and state superintendent Lane my name is Ashley Levins my school Oscar Smith High School in the Chesapeake School Division is the vice president school of the Virginia Student Council's Association thank you for the opportunity to speak before you this morning. According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, the amount of children in the U.S. diagnosed with anxiety and/or depression aged 6 to

[00:33:31] 17 years increased from 5.4 percent in 2003 to 8 percent in 2007 and to 8.4 percent in 2011 to 2012, not including the cases that go unreported. From there, it has only increased. According to the Association for Children's Mental Health, over 50 percent of students with emotional or behavioral disabilities ages 14 and older drop out of high school students quite obviously need help help that is not currently being provided to them by the place that is supposed to be the most adequately catered to their futures when I was 13 my friend busted me for harming myself and thankfully she told our English

[00:34:08] teacher my teacher had a long talk with me about my mental health outside of her classroom and then sent me to my guidance counselor who did nothing else but call my mother and recommend a mental health specialist well I got the help that I needed because of my supportive mother other students are not so lucky if I did not have any other supportive adults in my life and I had to rely solely on at-school

help from my guidance counselor I would have definitely continued the same harmful behaviors if not worse school is stressful for almost all students whether they are struggling with mental illness or not whether it is exams family stressors or even just being a teenager neurotypical teenagers are in the same desperate need for mental health

[00:34:45] counseling as those that have been formally diagnosed with a mental health disorder moreover teachers having to talk students down like this quite frankly, is not in their job description. Teachers and students alike have to deal with enough as it is. The need for mental health counselors in public schools is evident, and students deserve to have someone on their side who is trained to deal with mental health issues, big or small.

[00:35:07] The American School Counselor Association states that 20% of students that are in need of mental health services are in need of mental health services, and only one in five of those students will receive the help that they need. What about the other four? Coming from a diagnosed mentally ill student taking rigorous classes in the international baccalaureate diploma program mental illness can be a huge roadblock in education taking away the motivation and desire to perform well in school or to even show up having a trained professional in each school building will undoubtedly raise test scores attendance and eventually graduation rates preparing students for brighter futures is that not the ultimate goal if we claim to care about students and their futures we must

[00:35:46] provide all of the necessary resources to help them thrive both inside and outside of the classroom thank you thank you very much hillary jean bart good morning president gecker vice president atkinson members of the state and superintendent lane my name is hillary jean bart my school at massaponics high school in the spalzavania school division is a secretary school for the virginia student councils associate association as an 18 year old senior that has lived in virginia since

[00:36:22] kindergarten i can say that i have taken my fair share of sol tests sorry personally because i have have taken many advanced classes all my life i have never really had a major issue with passing my yearly sols unfortunately i definitely see myself within the minority as many of my peers have struggled to pass various standardized tests these and other current issues pushed me and the other students of the vsca to ask the state board of education to change the current model of testing in our state in the past i can say that i've had to take many sol tests in subjects that i was not enrolled in simply to fill a requirement because we were taking ap tests that did not exactly line

[00:36:58] up with this a certain specific sol test we were first forced to learn overflowed material weeks before the test my peers and i felt that the students meticulously studied only to fill fulfill a requirement and not to prepare for a test on what we had learned over the past eight months due to this our scores certainly did not feel that it clearly reflected our personal performance in class this leads to the greater issue of the sol test not really being accessible or passable for certain students with disabilities students with these learning disabilities or language barriers often struggle with reading heavy format of the SOL test. To possibly combat

[00:37:33] this issue, tests should be similar to AP exams in our opinion, where it's based on comprehension and understanding with more free response answers and less multiple choice questions. Another major issue students see in class is a lack of deviation within history courses due to the abundant and restrictive scope of knowledge needing to pass the SOL test. It appears to us that teachers are forced into teaching within the guidelines of the standards of learning and rarely have time to talk about the

subjects that many of us feel have genuine importance as a racial minority i have noticed that within our current system there is a serious lack of education on topics such as african-american figures and their achievements native american history and culture and asian

[00:38:12] american history as well these topics deserve to be emphasized more and i hope that in the future they will be included in our curriculum though as an individual i believe that our state evaluations are necessary and provide valuable experiences that will help students prepare for other standardized tests i still believe that there is room for improvement i appreciate the hard work that has gone into crafting our education and i hope that you will consider the points i have made today when moving forward thank you thank you jr snow good morning thank you

[00:38:52] for the opportunity to speak today on behalf and in support of the 2020 fine arts standards of learning review my name is jr snow and i have the privilege of serving the teachers and students of Harrisonburg City Schools as the visual and performing arts coordinator and serving the Commonwealth as the lead content consultant for music education for the 2020 Fine Arts Standards of Learning Review. In May 2019, the planning and leadership of this revision began through the dedicated vision and leadership of Kelly Bessonio and in conjunction with my colleagues Andrew Watson and Tara Taylor. A deep and focused effort started and continues to be implemented to ensure that these revisions uphold the quality of the 2013 standards and allow for a vision for

[00:39:31] for the future of arts education in Virginia, authentically connected to the profile of a Virginia graduate and the five C's. The content revision teams made up of teachers from around the Commonwealth shared their passions and expertise through conflict, discussion, decision-making and resolution to ensure our new standards reflect not only the growth and power of the past in arts education, but also the potential of what arts education will be.

[00:39:56] These revisions show a specific focus toward the creative process and innovation in the arts that I believe will move teaching and learning forward in new and powerful ways. Innovation cannot be misplaced simply as new technology. Innovation is the practice of thinking and learning with creativity at the core.

[00:40:13] The tools of technology fuse with that innovative mindset allow for the risk and failure that innovation demands and helps students grow from where they are to where they want to be. The creative artistic process demands innovation and is a sure catalyst for students to engage in areas they don't know yet.

[00:40:31] Innovation in music has changed the way we listen, create, produce, distribute, and experience music in our headphones, our cars, our homes, and concert venues. Composition and creation aren't limited only to large recording studios or learned professionals from accredited institutions.

[00:40:49] The sound of the new music creation lives in the mind of a student in Virginia, waiting to be unleashed and connected through a passionate teacher and a vibrant classroom. These standards in innovation will allow curriculum to be created, adjusted and adapted to ensure music, dance, theater, and visual art are available to more diverse student learners than ever before.

[00:41:10] As a product of Virginia public schools, both secondary and collegiate, and almost 21 years of service to multiple divisions in the Commonwealth, I would like to thank the Department of Education for providing and supporting well-rounded and innovative educational opportunities for the students in

Virginia that include the arts as a fundamental part of the portfolio of student understanding and accomplishment.

[00:41:31] The opportunity to support the revision collaborate with colleagues has been a true highlight of my career. The revised standards in front of you are stronger, more focused, more innovative, and more connected to our work in education and will lead the opportunity for evolution in arts education. I support these revisions and encourage the board to accept the proposed 2020 fine arts standards of learning. Thank you again for the opportunity to comment today. Thank you. Todd Lynn. Good morning members

[00:42:10] of the board and Dr. Lane. My name is Todd Lynn and I am the supervisor of Career and Technical Education for Shenandoah County Public Schools. Throughout the year, we as public school officials continue to be concerned that the funding levels that we have had with the Carl Perkins Act may get adjusted to a lower percentage of allocated funds for public schools. A decrease in Perkins V funding would prove to be detrimental to many programs and ultimately students of Shenandoah County Public Schools and across the Commonwealth. While we respect what our folks with the community colleges do, there are some significant differences. First, public schools don't have a revenue stream other than through state funding or local governing bodies to receive funding, which is not consistent anywhere across the Commonwealth.

[00:42:48] If a cut is made to Plans 5 for public schools, the only way to offset this is through local funds or to go without. We do not have the option of funding revenue through tuition and fees. We are the pipeline for the community college, and the better we prepare students to enter the workforce or further education, the more likely students will succeed at the next level.

[00:43:08] The increased burden on citizens in the small rural communities like Shenandoah County is hard to manage with the growing needs in other areas in education and other services. In the public education sector in the Commonwealth and throughout the Virginia General Assembly legislation we know the project the profile of a graduate is evolving and requiring us to have the most state-of-the-art equipment and allow Virginia students to have training for highly skilled high demand jobs. That expectation is on Virginia public schools. I personally support the opportunities that the profile of a graduate provides students particularly at the high school level regarding career readiness in the five seats. However, we cannot provide the best learning environment without the adequate funding. This leads me to my next point. I continue to hear a lot about

[00:43:46] equity in education. Public schools serve every student that walks through our doors. Every student. Purpose 5 funding allows every student in grades 5 through 12 the opportunity to gain access to career and technical education. I could give you many examples of students who provide opportunities made available through Perkins funds. That if these funds were not available, those opportunities would disappear. Based on the populations within our community, the career and technical education courses that are funded through Perkins are one way that we are trying to break the cycle of poverty for our families and students to prepare for the future. Additionally, as a

[00:44:21] CTE supervisor, I'm well-connected with our business partners, and most of them tell us that they will provide post-secondary education opportunities once the students have the skills necessary for employment. In public education, we're consistently working to continue to improve opportunities for every child. We serve about 4,700 students in CTE as presented by the SEDF report and we last year we committed we were able to record over 500 meaningful career experiences for students in our own pace to

do over 700 this year. Based on the 2019 on-time graduation report, Shenandoah County Public Schools graduated 95.2 percent of its students on time

[00:44:59] and 99 percent of its CTE completers on time. With all due respect to our community college partners, they listed 27% graduation rate serving a select group of a little over 18,000 students that made the decision to attend. I would ask that at a minimum you maintain the 85-15% split for public education and consider 90% and 10% if you were to reallocate funds. Thank you

[00:45:23] again for your time and appreciate the opportunity to speak. Thank you. Tara Taylor. Thank you for the opportunity to comment on agenda item J, the proposed revisions to the fine arts standards of learning. My name is Tara Taylor and I am the Theater and Dance Educational Specialist for Fairfax County Public Schools and served as the lead content consultant for theater and dance

[00:45:59] in the recent review and revisions of the Virginia Fine Arts Standards of Learning. First and foremost, I am here today as a former theater and dance student and a long-time public school theater arts teacher. Under the capable leadership of Kelly Bisonio, thoughtful and detailed attention was paid and the review and the revision of the fine arts standards incorporating stakeholder feedback and working with teacher curriculum teams the revisions that were made invigorated and vertically aligned content standards while synthesizing the five c's outlined and the profile of a virginia graduate revisions made also support technology integration and innovative practices

[00:46:39] for the fine arts while providing inclusive language that support diverse student learning communities. A significant addition made during the review and revision process was the inclusion of elementary standards of learning for both theater and dance. This is an overdue and an important addition to our theater and dance curriculum documents. As a former Virginia public schools teacher, now arts administrator, I am grateful how Virginia models excellence in arts education and supports theater and dance programs in our secondary schools. However, Comparatively, theater and education students lack equal access and important opportunities

[00:47:17] in these content areas. Dance education encourages health, fitness, musicality, critical thinking, collaboration, a unique discipline which supports all students regardless of language proficiency or background. Theater education supports active listening, empathy with diverse characters and perspectives, language acquisition, technical skills, and encourages students with varied skills and aptitudes to work together in order to produce and perform a creative shared vision.

[00:47:47] That's awesome. These unique educational experiences must be available for all elementary students, not just those with the economic means to participate in private programs. Clearly this addition encourages the growth, longevity and continued success of our K through 12 theater and dance and fine arts programs, as well as provides robust interdisciplinary and arts integration instructional strategies for Common Core teachers.

[00:48:14] Thank you for the opportunity to comment on Agenda Item J. In summary, I request and encourage the Virginia Board of Education to accept the proposed 2020 Fine Arts Standards of Learning for first review, including the addition of the Elementary Theater and Dance Standards of Learning.

[00:48:34] - Thank you. Jason Sir. - Good morning, Mr. President. - Good morning. - Members of the Board, Dr. Lane. My name is Jason Sir, CTE Director for Roanoke County Public Schools.

[00:48:51] you for the opportunity to speak with you this morning regarding funding for career and technical education opportunity is a great word we use in roanoke county schools we feel it best sums up what we in career and technical education provide for our students we are working to help students become opportunity ready ready to take advantage of whatever opportunities come their way the five c's that are the basis of the profile of a graduate are the skills businesses have told their us their workers need to develop in order to be successful in the workplace what better way to

[00:49:29] develop the five c's than through the engaging and purposeful deeper learning opportunities that cte instruction provides and the investment in our cte programs pays off don't take my word for it. Here are the facts. In Roanoke County, more than 99% of our CTE completers passed their English end-of-year SOL test, 100% passed the math end-of-year test, more than 93% earned an industry certification, more than 99% of CTE completers graduated on time, more than 97% of

[00:50:08] our completers joined the workforce, enrolled in the military, or pursued post-secondary education following graduation. Our CTE graduates are successful and have become an important part of advancing Virginia's economy. Our CTE programs depend on state and federal Perkins funding to provide critical important equipment for our labs and workshops, items that have to be updated to meet changing industry standards. Perkins funding helps us promote CTE programs to non-traditional students and to students with special needs and helps offset costs for those students to participate

[00:50:45] in important state and national competitions. If the state were to adopt any change less than the current 85 percent of Perkins funding, Roanoke County could lose up to $36,000. That may not sound like much when compared to the overall budget, but the impact to our students would be felt. Community colleges are able to generate revenue in various ways. They can charge tuition, impose fees, and mandate that students pay for books, software, computers, and other equipment.

[00:51:12] Community colleges receive dual enrollment tuition from high school students, even though the students are sitting in a high school classroom being taught by a high school teacher and using resources facilities and equipment provided by the high school in short we recommend a perkins funding ratio that allocates even more funding to where it is needed most secondary public schools we support a reallocation formula for perkins of 90 to secondary cte programs this would help public education better implement new engaging and purposeful initiatives that would enhance the positive impact on our CTE students and our high quality programs.

[00:51:48] Thank you for your time and consideration of this matter. Thank you. Mary Beth Echeverria, please. Good morning. Mr. President, members of the board, Dr. Lane, I am Mary Beth Echeverria, supervisor of career and technical education in Frederick County Public Schools, a member of the Virginia ACTE, and a board member of the Virginia Association of Career and technical education administrators cte courses touch 100 percent of public school students

[00:52:28] providing them the opportunity to identify their career pathways early the future workforce the keys to economic success are sitting in our classrooms right now one of our graduates a product of a high school agriculture program a college graduate and president of his own company in frederick county says this about cte with employers talking about the need for new hires to have soft skills there's no better place to learn these than in CTE. CTE produces young people who are ready to successfully enter the workforce or higher education by the time they graduate high school rather than those people who leave with a diploma only to find out what real life is and not be

[00:53:07] ready. He understands that students in secondary schools are the beginning of the workforce pipeline and the then that investing in workforce work based learning can pay dividends. He has taken a front row seat to scout the talent And he hires our students.

[00:53:24] The Frederick County Public Schools Director of Facility Services understands that as well. He has hired two youth registered apprentices in two years to grow his workforce. And new business partners are coming on board rapidly to do the same. In Frederick County Public Schools, there are many student successes associated with CTE including academic achievement, impactful work-based learning, and leadership development through career and technical student organizations.

[00:53:47] Additional measures of success published annually by BDOE show that over 98% of our Our completers pass their end-of-course SOLs. You've heard data like that before. And they graduate of a rate of nearly 99%, well above the state average. That's very impressive.

[00:54:03] And you've heard that data again as well from my colleagues. Additionally, over half of our CTE completers earn an advanced studies diploma, and a number of students participating in work-based learning, it's growing exponentially. This is not unique to Frederick County, as you've heard, the state or the nation.

[00:54:18] CTE works, and it works by meeting students' needs interests engaging them in their own learning developing ownership motivating them and at the same time meeting the needs of our communities so as a ct administrator i'm committed to growing these programs based on industry need and student interest my work is an investment for the economic health of my community and the commonwealth but it is a daunting task with insufficient funding equipping labs for optimal optimal safety and instruction upskilling our faculty maintaining industry standards and providing meaningful work-based learning experiences are expensive.

[00:54:55] Supplemental funding through Perkins is essential to prepare our students not only for those jobs of today, but those jobs of tomorrow. With the new iteration of Perkins V, I ask the funding formula to increase to 90 percent for secondary schools. I think it's very clear that a larger investment in CTE at the secondary level is a sound investment and one that will have significant impact on the health of our commonwealth.

[00:55:17] Thank you. - Thank you, and I always appreciate the gentle correction of the pronunciation of the name, so thank you for that. - Sir, it wasn't a correction, so please take no offense. - No, none, none. I'm very serious about that. It's hard to just keep reading names.

[00:55:32] - It's not an easy name, but thank you so much. - Chad Macklin, please. - Good morning, and thank you board for having us today and Dr. Lane for allowing us the opportunity to speak.

[00:55:51] My name's Chad Macklin. I'm the current education director in Chesterwood County Public Schools. What I'll start with, I was a student under Perkins II. I was a teacher of CTE under Perkins III. I became an administrator in Perkins IV, and I'm now still an administrator in Perkins V. So this is my life with 45 years in public education and product in Virginia, secondary, elementary, secondary, and post-secondary schools.

[00:56:15] So I speak passionately and personally from this point of view. As the CTE Director in Church of Becoming Public Schools, again, I'm gonna advocate for additional funding needed for CTE and the split for Perkins V. There's been lots of reasons stated for why, and they're all accurate and correct.

[00:56:32] In light of this, CTE is a proven track record, not only in Virginia, but nationally, about student success and graduation rate with a national graduation rate of 96.68% of all academic programs. And that's housed by Virginia State.

[00:56:48] The state directors of CTE and ACT support that nationally. So it speaks to CTE works, and CTE works in Virginia. CTE is critical to middle school and high school career students um as they achieve their passions to their prosperity that's our goal is how do we help connect students to their future their prosperity this is an opportunity to explore but over the last decade and since 2000 and since perkins 4 was initiated in 2007 and where we are today there have been many additional requirements uh placed upon local schools from career investigations academic and career plan work-based learning economic personal finance and alignments

[00:57:27] of programs and national to national standard organizations these have all placed on new hardships on school divisions with either maintaining funding or decreased funding at the state and federal level as as fiscal years have waned in mode with with funding looking forward just regarding public schools is investing in experiential learning and supporting that all current education students will have multiple experiences along the continuum of work-based learning we believe students have to have multiple experiences to get out of the classroom and to affirm, yes, this is my passion, yes, this is my future, and have the opportunity to interact with business on a personal level.

[00:58:03] We invest in that. Maintaining the funding formula of 85% to secondary and 15% to post-secondary causes additional hardships on local school divisions and budgets. An increase in funding formula 90% or higher secondary education would assist in school divisions to close the funding gaps and address the policy mandates of new initiatives in Perkins 5.

[00:58:26] I thank you for the opportunity to speak today, I thank you for your consideration and the great work that the staff and the VDOE office have done around the Commonwealth with transparency, collecting information, seeking feedback from varied stakeholders, and the opportunity to have spoken across the state at three different regional meetings where they were seeking input. The work that they've done to align this Perkins 5 plan is great. As a former state director of the District of Columbia, I know the work that was put in front of them, and it's difficult to take all sides. It's difficult to put a plan together, but I think the plan they put together is exceptionally excellent. It speaks to the needs that we need.

[00:59:00] Only the difference is I would look for a funding increase at the secondary level for many of the reasons I've been spoken of previously today. Thank you. Thank you. Mary Beth Dobbins. Good morning, Mr. President, board members, and Dr. Lane. My name is Mary Beth Dobbins, and I'm the CTE coordinator for Prince William County Public Schools. First, I'd like to publicly thank the Virginia Department of Education staff and the staff at the CTE Resource Center for the remarkable support they provide to all of our cte teachers throughout the commonwealth

[00:59:38] virginia has consistently been at the forefront of initiatives that increase student preparation and success in addition i'm here to advocate for the virginia state plan to keep the same designated split of perkins funds at a minimum between k-12 and post-secondary institutions the 85 percent to k-12 and 15 percent to post-secondary is needed to continue the statewide annual performance of students the funds for k-12 are divided among 132 school divisions the funds for the virginia commonwealth excuse me community college system are divided among 23

[01:00:15] community colleges vccs has other access to other funding streams and sources while local school divisions do not vccs has the ability to increase tuition rates and add-on fees for courses and activities and VCCS does not provide textbooks to students. On the other hand, local school divisions cannot raise tuition or fees and must provide textbooks and instructional materials for all of our students. If the funds to K-12 were to be reduced, the negative impact on resources and services provided will harm student performance outcomes. A decrease would require a reduction in

[01:00:53] things such as teacher professional development, equipment purchases, industry certification preparation software and testing, just to name a few. A few years ago, a student at Forest Park High School in our division became the first American to ever take home a world championship trophy at the Microsoft Office Specialist World Championship competition. Would he have been that successful if we were not able to provide his teachers with the professional development they needed to support his learning, student access to the latest online resources and textbooks,

[01:01:27] the opportunity to earn multiple industry certifications, and computer labs that provided access to current software and equipment needed to prepare for his future. In closing, Prince William County Public Schools rely on VDOE and the CTE Resource Center staff members for our teachers to deliver the high-quality, world-class instruction that they do.

[01:01:50] Our students expect and deserve to have the equipment and program improvements necessary to become competitive in the workforce or in post-secondary education endeavors. It's vital that the funding remain at least at the current level if we are to sustain the programs and initiatives we have proposed for the benefit of our students and the local economy.

[01:02:13] Our division continues to add students, programs, and schools. schools. The state continues to ask school divisions to do more. Include fifth graders in the population of students Perkins funding supports. Determine a plan to incorporate the computer science standards in K-12 education. Increase. Thank you for your time and attention.

[01:02:32] I've provided my written comments as well as data that I hope you'll have a chance to take a look at that supports it. Thank you. Thank you very much. Mac Beaton, please. Good morning, Mr. President, members of the board, Mr. Superintendent. My name is Mac and I'm the director of career and technical education for Henrico County Public Schools and I appreciate the opportunity to address the board about the value and importance of maintaining the funding through Perkins 5 for

[01:03:11] students in secondary schools I'd like to open my comments with two questions is having our students graduate from high school college and career ready enough or do we want them to graduate college and career prepared second question is how will put Perkins 5 funding affect the answer to this question. There are many reasons for continuing support of and interest in CTE programs at the secondary level. One of the most compelling is the widely publicized skills gap. A high-quality CTE program reflects the needs of business and industry and ensures our students are well-prepared to

[01:03:50] meet these needs. Implementing CTE programs with fidelity and equity requires all schools and students have access to the type of equipment and resources utilized in the industry. Perkins 5 funding helps ensure that students learn utilizing state-of-art equipment so they are prepared to enter a high-demand, high-paying career.

[01:04:12] How can you teach a student to operate a four-axis computer-controlled numerical milling machine on a manual three-axis machine? While some of the skills may be transferable, the student would not be able to operate the equipment that industry already has in place. Without state-of-the-art equipment, they are not prepared to move forward. Perkins funding allows school divisions to offer CTE teachers staff development opportunities. Continual learning is a must, and Perkins 5 provides the funding that will enable CTE teachers to get specialized training that is needed to prepare our students.

[01:04:52] Perkins funding provides opportunities for our students to be leaders by participating in student organizations. Students participating in CTSOs gain enhanced job-specific knowledge and skills critical to future careers. These events help our students transfer knowledge gained in the classroom to authentic career-related situations, helping them to be prepared for the future.

[01:05:19] How do we measure the competency of our CTE students? Last year in Henrico, students earned over 6,100 industry-based certification. Not only does Perkins Funds help support the cost of the certification for many students, it helps ensure our teachers are trained adequately and the equipment is sufficient to prepare students to be successful.

[01:05:43] So the question becomes, is having our students graduate college and career ready enough or do we want our students to graduate college and career prepared as well by maintaining or increasing the 85 15 split for perkins five we can assure that our students are ready and prepared leaving secondary education to enter a high demand high paying

[01:06:06] career for now and in the future thank you very much thank you andrew watson please good morning thank you for letting me address you today in support of the standards of learning revision for the Fine Arts. My name is Andrew Watson. I live in Fairfax County, Virginia, and I'm the Fine Arts Specialist for the Alexandria City Public Schools. I served as a member of the Fine Arts

[01:06:43] Standards Revision Steering Committee and was a content consultant for the Visual Arts Standards Revision under the very capable leadership of VDOE Fine Arts Coordinator Kelly Vazono. I am here to share my excitement and support for the proposed revisions. I could spend a long time talking to you about the these standards support cultural learning innovation and technology and across media or how they've been thoroughly streamlined for ease of use but time is short so let me focus on how our new strands center on the most essential aspects of the arts and how

[01:07:18] these closely align with the video ease focus on the five c's the new strand of creative process emphasizes the importance of how we make art and how we solve problems it makes the metacognitive process visible for both teachers and students this aligns closely with the creative thinking skill the five c's while the arts are important for their own sake significant research suggests that this process is transferable to non-arts areas and is a critical component to nurture future innovation the new strand of critical thinking and communication directly supports

[01:07:54] the two skills of the same name as well as aspects of collaboration under this standard strand students acquire skills of analysis and evaluation which along with the skill of creating found under the previous strand cover all the higher order thinking skills of bloom's taxonomy this strand also covers how students learn to communicate through their artwork and about artwork both verbally and in writing finally this strand covers how student artists collaborate on projects and performances it covers skills like compromise shared responsibility active listening

[01:08:29] and giving constructive feedback. The new strand of history, culture, and citizenship emphasizes the context and purpose of why we create art. It covers the relationship between the arts and human history, how the arts span various cultures, and how the arts can be used as a tool for engaged citizens to instill values promoting positive change. While technique, craft, and medium are important art content, these new strands communicate the importance of the deeper lessons of the arts.

[01:09:02] as a career arts educator i want to thank you for allowing me to be part of this vital process and i encourage you to adopt these revised stand uh fine arts standards thank you thank you mike gettings president gecker members of the board superintendent lane my name is michael gettings and i'm representing the virginia coalition for fine arts education i also served as the middle

[01:09:40] school visual arts team lead during the process i am here to express the coalition's full support for the fine arts standards before i do that though i'd like to commend the positive leadership shown by kelly bosonio coordinator for fine arts under the direction of christine harris the director of the office of humanities kelly assembled a team of knowledgeable art educators from every region in the state these educators have deep content knowledge and practical experiences she made sure the teams were balanced and under her leadership they were very well together developing the fine arts standards that will inform the arts education for years to come the standards are aligned vertically and horizontally and lend to the

[01:10:20] spiraling curriculum development we use in the arts the standards demonstrate a mindfulness of diversity cultural sensitivity and inclusion the foundation of the standards is the virginia profile of the graduate fine arts students will connect art skills content and processes to career options college opportunities and 21st century workplace our students will also learn and demonstrate communication through arts works verbal and written responses demonstrating an understanding of the value of to listening to diverse opinions and responses of others

[01:10:54] the five c's which are in the standards directly and with fidelity learning with learning and demonstrate creative and critical thinking and problem solving skills collaboration ethics and legal considerations for engaging with resources and source materials a lifelong engagement with the arts, a working knowledge of emerging technologies, the thinking and artistic skills to create meaning in works of art. In closing, we have a robust and intentional set of standards.

[01:11:24] These fine arts standards of learning exemplify the expectations established by the profile of the Virginia graduate and are reflective of the skills and attributes students need to excel in the 21st century workplace. They balance technical problem with deeper thinking, problem-solving skills, and meaning making. These standards are mindful of diversity, cultural sensitivity, and inclusion. The standards are forward-looking and will lead to more productive and culturally aware of citizenry. Virginia should be proud as a leader in its support for arts education for all of our students. With these fine arts standards, the citizens of the Commonwealth

[01:12:00] have a program of fine arts education that is among the best in the nation. Thank you. Thank you. Dr. William Crowder. Good morning. Thank you, President Gecker, Vice President Atkinson, members of the board, Mr. Superintendent and colleagues.

[01:12:28] Thank you for this opportunity this morning to come before you to talk about the implications of Perkins V and what it means to students, teachers, schools, and school divisions. My name is William Crowder. I'm the Assistant Director of Workforce and Career Development in Henrico County Public Schools. Perkins funding for CTE is something that has impacted me on a personal level as a former CTE

student, teacher, and current administrator. Prior to my current position, I was Principal of the Advanced Career Education Center at Holland Springs in Henrico County, which is one of two full-service CT centers in the county. I'd like to speak this

[01:13:05] more of how I have seen Perkins firsthand have a positive and lasting impact on students. In addition, I would like to discuss the broader implications of Perkins funding across the state. Because of your generosity with past appropriations of Perkins funds, you have provided substantial opportunities, not only for our students in Henrico, but students across the Commonwealth of Virginia. Perkins funding has provided us unique learning opportunities to otherwise not otherwise available to our students such as the ability to compete in career and technical student organizations ctsos competitions at the district state even the

[01:13:44] national level with current budget challenges these are opportunities that would not exist without perkins funding over the years perkins funds have allowed students to compete at the national level in various ctsos fact one of our newest teachers in our county was a former student in our program, competed at the national level as a student. During his interview, he talked about the opportunities that CTE gave him and opportunities that he would not have had and never would have dreamed or imagined. Enrollment in Henrico County's CTE program

[01:14:18] has continually increased annually. With a duplicate count of almost 25,000 students, an additional CTE center slated to open in the fall of 2022, additional funding is greatly needed. Our business and industry partners continue to express concern that equipment needs meet industry standards so as to best prepare our students for the workforce.

[01:14:42] This concern is echoed across our neighboring school divisions as well. State-of-the-art equipment allows our students to learn in an environment that is comparable to the workforce environment in their respective industry. The addition of the required personal finance and economics classes has also created a strain on the budget for a more traditional CTE courses, which is one reason we're asking that funding structure be increased in favor of secondary education.

[01:15:10] Finally, Henrico County is home to the CTE Resource Center that provides resources for all CTE courses across the Commonwealth. Almost 70% of the budget for this center comes from Perkins Funds. This center is vital and paramount to the success of CT programs across the state, and it's my belief that you would hear this sentiment echoed across many school divisions.

[01:15:34] Teacher support, professional development, curriculum revision, development of new courses, and establishment of the 17th Career Cluster in Energy are just a few of the many things the CT Resource Center offers. It is the utmost importance that funding remain available to ensure Virginia CT's curriculum keeps pace with the career and workforce needs. Thank you.

[01:15:56] - Thank you, Georgia Casper. - Good morning, everyone. Before I begin, I wanted to state how appropriate this topic is because it's very timely.

[01:16:17] CTE month is February. I am Georgia Casper, career and technical education coordinator with Chesterfield County Public Schools, a large school division with 13 middle schools, 11 high schools, two technical centers, and about 62,000 students.

[01:16:34] Chesterfield County Public Schools has more than 23,000 students enrolled in career and technical education courses, of which over 1,650 are career and technical education completers.

Chutchfield County Public Schools employs more than 150 full-time CTE teachers and administrators each year.

[01:16:56] Last year, more than 9,000 CTE industry certifications were earned by our students. This accomplishment could not have been achieved without the high industry standards we have set for our students in our high-tech learning environments.

[01:17:14] Our classrooms are supported by Chesterfield County Public Schools, as well as our local business community. But most are supported by the federal funding we receive from the Carl D. Perkins Act. Chesterfield County Public Schools has time and time again delivered on its investment with consistent above state level performance on its report card.

[01:17:37] These high performances can be attributed to the federal investment and responsive fiscal management of those resources aligned with career and technical education implementation plan. Local funding is bridging the gap for the federal and state funding.

[01:17:57] During the 18-19 school year, Chesterfield County Public Schools spent over $190,000 on industry certifications, of which $30,000 was paid utilizing Perkins funding. As a result, the federal investment in industry certifications was roughly 25% toward this important and vital measure of workforce readiness.

[01:18:22] Increasing the funding will give more students more access to industry certifications, allowing high school students to validate their knowledge and skills and create better opportunities for their future. I believe that career and technical education is a local, county, state, and federal government investment, a partnership.

[01:18:45] I urge the board to support increasing the funding for the career and technical education secondary programs above the 85% threshold. Thank you for your time and commitment to the students of the Commonwealth of Virginia and to this important workforce development program.

[01:19:04] - Thank you. Teagan Sealy, please. - Good morning. - Good morning.

[01:19:20] - Thank you to the Virginia Board of Education for the opportunity to speak this morning on behalf of EverFi. EverFi is a technology company that is driving social change through education to address the most challenging issues affecting society today. And the courses we offer range from financial literacy and career readiness to prescription drug safety and mental wellness.

[01:19:39] Since its founding, EverFi has reached more than 25,000 schools nationwide through the use of our digital platform. In Virginia specifically, last year alone, more than 600 schools, 1,700 teachers, and 136,000 students across 118 divisions turned to EverFi as a way to address some of the most pressing issues facing the next generation.

[01:20:00] While we started our work with Virginia, schools in the career and technical education space focused on financial literacy. In the past two years, we have expanded our offerings to include mental wellness basics and prescription drug safety. Through interactive scenarios and self-guided activities, these prevention lessons are designed to be easily implemented in any school, and thanks to our local partnerships, all schools across the Commonwealth are able to receive these resources at no cost.

[01:20:25] More than 4,400 students in the Commonwealth have participated in the prescription drug safety resource, and more than 6,400 Virginia students have participated in the Mental Wellness Basics

resource. And for students who complete these resources, we see noticeable gains in both knowledge and attitudinal behavior changes.

[01:20:42] Students in Virginia who completed Mental Wellness Basics had a 17-point improvement in understanding mental health, including the warning signs, symptoms, and treatments of common mental health disorders. Additionally, we saw positive attitudinal behavior changes with a 13-point increase in students self-reporting that if they felt they needed help with mental health issues, they would seek help without hesitation.

[01:21:04] These gains show proficiency in meeting proposed health standards 10.2N and 10.2K. In mental wellness basics, students address proposed standard 10.2N by engaging in simulations that teach them how to recognize when help is needed and how to access it for oneself and for others.

[01:21:20] Students also address stigma and how it can hinder help-seeking behaviors by responding to five scenarios and practicing how they would approach each one. Virginia students also increase their knowledge gains around prescription drug safety, with students showing a 23-point increase in their knowledge surrounding the science of addiction, including the influence of drugs on the brain, which shows a relation to the proposed standards 9.1J, 9.2J, 9.3I, 10.1H, 10.1G, and 10.3G.

[01:21:48] In prescription drug safety, students address proposed standard 9.3I by learning the four-step process to stepping in, noticing a problem, deciding to act, determining what to do, support, and recovery. Students also explore different warning signs and ways to find help for someone who might be abusing drugs, and they explore specific signs of abuse for opioids, depressants, and stimulants.

[01:22:10] Lessons like the ones previously described contributed to a 50-point knowledge gain in Virginia students recognizing the signs of a drug overdose, recognizing drug misuse and abuse, and knowing about effective bystander interventions. EverFi is looking forward to continue to work along the Virginia Department of Education to provide resources, data, and support to educators as they adopt these new health standards.

[01:22:32] Thank you. - Thank you. That concludes the list of speakers who have signed up. Is there anybody else who would like to address the board? - I don't know, I guess it's selfie time instead.

[01:22:55] Keep waiting for Dr. Wilson to take that selfie. Okay. All right, then we're gonna, yes, okay. Ms. Holton, you are recognized.

[01:23:10] - With the president's permission, I just wanted before any of the students leave, I wanna particularly thank you as the president said, We don't normally comment in response to the public comment, but we do listen and take your input into consideration in all kinds of ways. But you all just called for me to ask for permission to deviate from our process today to say how valuable it was to have your input, to have you here.

[01:23:34] And we're just eager for your -- as you see, we've got a number of things on our agenda today that relate directly to some of the issues you raised, what we often do, and we're eager for student input, and we do get individual student comments on things like our health education standards that we're considering today that address mental health issues in a big way, but I don't know that we structurally get enough input from students on a regular basis, and we'd love to include you all more vigorously as stakeholders to have you comment on things on our agenda, either in writing or in person any time.

[01:24:09] incredibly valuable in your your presentations today were wonderful so thank you for that permission okay we will now close public comment thank you miss Holton move on to the consent agenda I understand we want to pull item item C at least as regards Fairfax County correct use this let's just pull it as regards Fairfax we'll vote on that separately yes thank you and with that pulled is there a motion or to either adopt or approve the cons items on the consent agenda or remove another item for a debate.

[01:24:47] All right, so we're gonna move to, I guess, approve those items with the exception of Fairfax County and item C. Thank you, is there a second? Thank you, Dr. Wilson. All those in favor, signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed, any abstentions? Okay, and now just to clean up item C for Fairfax, is there a motion to approve that item?

[01:25:08] Thank you, Dr. Wilson, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Ms. Atkinson. No discussion. All those in favor, signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Aye. - Opposed, and then-- - Abstain. - One abstention. Okay, we move on to item E, final review of proposed revisions to the health education standards of learning.

[01:25:42] - Good morning. - Good morning. - President Gecker, Vice President Atkinson, members of the board, Dr. Lane, I appreciate the opportunity to present for final review proposed revisions to the health education standards of learning. I would like to take this opportunity to thank Dr. Duran, Dr. Mann, Ms. Holton, Ms. Atkinson, Dr. Wilson, and Mrs.

[01:26:07] Davis Vaught for presiding over the public hearings at Fairfax, Virginia Beach, and Roanoke. I can tell you that it's a bit daunting to present to the State Board of Education, but many of the presenters expressed appreciation for the welcoming gracious atmosphere created by the board at these public hearings the public comment and public hearings yielded extensive public input from teachers administrators curriculum supervisors state agencies and other

[01:26:43] subject matter experts the feedback was overwhelmingly positive and many expressed that reorganizing the health content and skills by topic will enhance instruction provide clear expectations for student learning clarity for parents and help students define their personal values and beliefs understand the dangers of vaping the importance of mental wellness and social emotional skills and decrease the stigma related to mental health public comments

[01:27:17] also included programmatic concerns about the lack of time and commitment for providing health instruction at the elementary level the need to amend the soa to require equal time for health and physical education instruction at the secondary level and the need to reduce allowable class size for physical education below 40 to 50 students more reasonable class size for health instruction In light of the positive feedback from stakeholders for the proposed changes to the health standards,

[01:27:55] the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board approve the proposed revisions to the 2020 Health Education Standards of Learning. Thank you. Thank you. Are there any questions or other comments? No. If not, is there a motion, and thank you very much for the presentation, is there a motion to approve the proposed revisions to the health education standards of learning so moved thank you dr dron thank you miss atkinson any discussion at all seeing none all in favor signify by saying aye aye opposed thank you and

[01:28:31] abstentions thank you okay item f uh first review of recommended cut scores i mean public comment welcome back thank you uh good morning president geck our members of the board and dr

lane I am here today to bring to you, for first review, recommended cut scores for the grades 3 through 8 and, of course, standards of learning reading test based on the 2017 English standards.

[01:29:11] I know we had a fairly lengthy discussion about this process yesterday, but I will be going through it again in a fair amount of detail as you consider this item on first review. As you know, each time we do administer new tests, it is the board's authority to determine what the cut scores are on those tests.

[01:29:35] And the standard setting process we have used for the last 21 years, I guess 22 years at this point, really is strongly grounded in teacher expertise, both their knowledge of the content of the Standards of Learning and also their knowledge and experience with students.

[01:29:59] And that is consistent with all of the work you do on the Standards of Learning. Teachers are intricately involved in the development of the content standards themselves. They also are convened in committees every summer and they review every test item that goes on a Standards of Learning test.

[01:30:20] And of course, we also involve them in the determination of the recommendations that we bring to you for what the cut scores should be. As I mentioned yesterday, the standard setting process that we use also recognizes the policy component of the tests.

[01:30:43] The tests are not only used to measure student achievement, but they're also used as one component or one indicator of evaluations of school quality. So we do recognize that there is a policy component to the decisions that are made about the cut scores. So the process begins by convening teachers from across the state. We have a separate committee for each test, so there's one for grade 3 reading, one for grade 4 reading, and so on. Those teachers do

[01:31:21] apply to be on these committees their superintendents have to recommend them and it is a fairly extensive vetting process we do try to make sure that we have representation from across the state also from rural areas and urban areas and suburban areas to the extent we can and we also try to make sure that we have teachers who are experienced in teaching students who are English learners and also students with disabilities. There are about 15 teachers or educators who

[01:31:58] sit on each of the committees that review the test for standard setting. I did want to mention to you that our testing contractor, Pearson, provides the facilitators for each of the committees. In my continuing attempt to explain jargon, psychometricians really are testing experts and their focus really is on the statistical characteristics of tests and so they are very experienced in the processes that are used to recommend cut scores and they do this

[01:32:34] across the country consistently when we have standard setting committees in virginia the psychometricians recognize the quality of our virginia teachers and i wanted you all to be aware that in a public session they provide compliments on their extensive knowledge of the standards of learning which speaks to the support that our instructional folks here provide to school divisions and also the school board office staff provides and also their deep understanding of the students

[01:33:11] that they teach so I just wanted to give a shout out to the teachers who sat on on the standard setting committees, and as we well know, they represent all of the teachers in Virginia. So with that said, the committees of teachers are convened for each of the tests.

[01:33:32] They go through fairly extensive training with the Pearson facilitators. And one of the first activities they do is they review the actual performance level descriptors that been developed for each of

the performance levels we have and the information I'm talking about now is an attachment A in your board item if you want to follow along so the performance level descriptors are also developed by teachers and it just it provides a description of what a proficient

[01:34:09] student for example in grade 3 reading should know and be able to do and you have an example of that in your materials so the the teachers review those performance level descriptors there's one for proficient one for advanced one for basic and one for fail below basic and they have a lot of discussions about the content that is included in those performance level descriptors the next thing they do is think about what knowledge and skills would be necessary for a student just over the line.

[01:34:46] So the performance level descriptors for proficient describe what a proficient student in a fairly broad range would be able to do. The teachers are trying to decide what would be the knowledge and skills that a student who's just over the proficient line would have to know.

[01:35:06] They do a similar activity for advanced. The reason they do this activity is to get in their minds a consistent understanding of the type of student they're thinking about, the one just over the proficient line as they review test items.

[01:35:25] So once they have an idea of what those skills and abilities are, they actually write them down and use them for reference. Then they begin reviewing the test items. And the majority of the standard setting process really is teachers reviewing the individual test items.

[01:35:47] And so in the document that's in attachment A, you'll notice that their next activity is called round one. So teachers independently review each item in the set of items, and they make a judgment about whether a student who is just proficient, just barely over the line, would get that item correct most of the time.

[01:36:10] And they do that for each item in the set of items they are reviewing. And so at the end of that process, each teacher has said either yes, the student should get it correct, or no, the student wouldn't get it correct for each item.

[01:36:28] And then that information is aggregated for each teacher. So, for example, if we'll just pretend that we had a 10-item test, the actual set of items they reviewed was much longer. But if we had a 10-item test and Dr. Wilson said that a Barely proficient student should get six of those items correct Her recommended cut score would be six out of ten suppose that Dr. Paxton Viewed that a student should only get ten of those items correct So her recommended cut score would be four out of ten

[01:37:06] So at the end of round one that information is provided to the the teacher committee So if you all were the committee, you would know what each of your colleagues recommended. So there's that level of information.

[01:37:23] And then in addition, the Pearson psychometricians identify items where there was a lot of disagreement. So maybe we have 15 panelists. There's an item where eight panelists said that a student should get it correct.

[01:37:42] Seven said that students would not. That would be the kind of item that was discussed. And the discussion revolves around what is the content of that item? How does it relate to those performance-level descriptors, particularly those that the teacher committee developed for students who are just over the line?

[01:38:06] And, you know, an extensive discussion about whether students should know that content to be proficient. That discussion is typically very lengthy because this is the first time teachers have had an opportunity to see what their colleagues thought and also an opportunity for them to really discuss the content they're seeing in the items.

[01:38:32] Following that long discussion, they conduct what is called round two. And again, they are reviewing the items individually and making judgments about whether a student who's just proficient would get that item correct most of the time.

[01:38:54] They do a similar activity for a student who's just advanced and one who is just basic. Following that round two activity, they again have a discussion. They are provided information about what their colleagues viewed as, and again have an extensive discussion about items where there is a lot of disagreement.

[01:39:19] Sometimes they adjust the descriptions they have of the students who are just proficient as a result of that discussion. Following that activity, again, their information is aggregated and provided to them, and then they go on to what is called round three.

[01:39:40] In round three, they're not actually reviewing items. This time, they're just given the opportunity to adjust their cut score. So Dr. Wilson may think, based on the discussion she's had with her colleagues, that perhaps she was too rigorous in her judgments, and so she's going to drop her recommended cut score from six out of 10 to 5 out of 10. Once that round 3 activity is completed, the majority of the teachers

[01:40:16] leave. The next activity that occurs is what we call the Articulation Committee. This committee has three representatives from each of the standard setting committees, so three teachers from grade 3, three from grade 4, three from grade 5, and so on. Those teachers meet the following day.

[01:40:44] Their purpose is more of a policy purpose. These teachers are asked to look at the recommendations that come out of each of the individual standard setting committees and make a judgment about whether or not those recommendations are reasonable.

[01:41:07] And if there are differences, is there a content basis for those differences? These teachers are given impact data, so they are given projections on if the cut scores were adopted, what would the impact be on the pass rates.

[01:41:31] If you will look at attachment B, I'll give you some information about what the articulation committee sees. The articulation committee is given the information that you are provided under background.

[01:41:51] the background information says in the second column the past proficient cut score for the new test if we were to maintain rigor. So the articulation committee is given that information so they know on grade three, for example, that if we were to maintain the same level of rigor on the new test as we have on the old, that the cut score would be 25 out of

[01:42:20] 40. They're also given the median of the round three individual standard setting committee. So remember, round three is where teachers have an opportunity to adjust their cut scores, and then we look at a range and pick the median or the middle score. So it is that median score which goes to articulation.

[01:42:52] And you'll see that for the grade three committee, the median for round three for that committee was 16 out of 40.

[01:43:08] In addition, the articulation committee spends a great deal of time looking at the performance level descriptors for each of the tests. Because they have not been involved in the review of the items for all of the tests, important for them to have a grounding in what are the expectations. So just to summarize, they go through a lengthy discussion of the performance level descriptors so they understand what is expected. The representatives from each of the individual committees talk to

[01:43:47] the large articulation committee about what their committee saw as the expectations. So, For example, the grade three representatives might talk about the knowledge and skills their committee saw as particularly important in grade three.

[01:44:07] And then the teachers are given the background information that I told you about in terms of what the cut score would be if we maintain the same level of rigor, the round three recommendation from the committee, and then we actually give them estimated impact data.

[01:44:28] So they see if we were to adopt the round three median recommendation, what would that impact be? If we were to recommend, if they were to adopt the round four, I'm sorry, the round three recommendation for grade four, what would that impact look like?

[01:44:48] And their task really is to look at that impact and make a judgment about if there is a difference in the impact, is there a content explanation for it? So let's say that maybe the impact data suggests that fewer students would pass the grade five reading test than would pass the grade six reading test.

[01:45:12] So the committee is charged with thinking about is there a content explanation for why there would be that difference. You'll notice as you look at this summary that you have the articulation committee's recommendation. And you'll notice that in many cases, they did make fairly significant changes to what the individual standard setting committee made. And part of that is that they did have the benefit of seeing the impact data and looking to make sure that what was

[01:45:49] being recommended was reasonable and also any differences could be explained through content. So just using grade three as an example again, you'll notice that Articulation raised the recommended cut score from 16 out of 40 to 21 out of 40.

[01:46:14] And you have this information for each of the tests. Following the work of the Articulation Committee, then we bring this information back to the department for review, and you'll see that you also have a recommendation from Dr. Lane.

[01:46:32] I expect he will probably talk about that recommendation. But I think in this situation, Dr. Lane's recommendation is an attempt to honor the recommendation of the teachers, but also to recognize any concern about a drop in rigor over time.

[01:46:57] This is on first review today, so you will have more time to talk about this you're not being asked to take action on it until until march um the superintendent's recommendation is that you accept it on first review and uh mr gecker i would be happy to respond to any questions okay thank you remember this is first review and also that we had significant discussion about this yesterday which is not to say we should not discuss it in depth today if that's the desire of the board but

[01:47:30] You know, I don't think we need to duplicate a lot of what was said yesterday here today. Are there any comments or questions, Ms. Holton? Thank you, Ms. Shelley, and with your patient explanation, and some of it, repeating some of it, I'm feeling like I understand the process better and better, and I'm grateful, but one piece that I feel like is just kind of a mystery box is the second column, the past proficient cut score for new tests to maintain previous level of rigor. That's the psychometrician

[01:48:06] column. I think I understand that correctly. You know, we all want something that's sort of objective and scientific that answers all of this. And now I feel like you've helped me understand the human factor work that goes into the teacher round and the articulation, the round three and the articulation committee, and it seems like very good, solid work. What I don't understand is, what is it the psychometricians do to, you know, I mean, sort of what the teachers are doing is trying to determine the level of rigor appropriate, et cetera, so what magic

[01:48:44] do they do and how objective is that and how much confidence should we put in the outcomes of what the psychometricians do? And I'm happy to take the answer either today or if you have more information to share with us in writing or otherwise before we vote next time.

[01:49:03] It is a statistical projection of if you took the particular cut score, what the cut score would be if to maintain the same level of rigor. So it is a statistical projection based really on last year's data.

[01:49:24] But does the same level of rigor mean like the same outcomes, you know, the same impact on the student data, or is it a question-by-question analysis like the teachers do? what goes into their black box? It's not a question-by-question analysis. It's taking the level of achievement statistically that was required on the old tests and applying it to the new items to tell you what the same, what the cut score would be if you maintained that same

[01:49:59] achievement. Maybe a way of thinking about it is it gives you an estimate of the difficulty of the test. But so are the teachers trying to do that. So, and they, you know, just using third grade by way of example, they came out with pretty wild, that may be the only one they came out with wildly different, but they did come out with different assessments on all of them, most of them, but wildly different in third grade. So, you know, how magic is, you know, how much confidence should I

[01:50:38] have in the magic of the experts and just to be clear this is not a Pearson recommendation it really is here to provide you with some context about you know what the cut score would be if if we were to maintain the same same level of rigor but when we do we all want to maintain the same level of rigor so it to me it sort of says oh well then we're dropping if we don't do that but then I'm hearing, understand the process that's producing the other numbers that's also aiming to maintain the same level of rigor but coming out with a different result.

[01:51:16] Maybe I can help here. So Pearson makes a recommendation to maintain the same level of rigor. They're not making a recommendation that that level of rigor is a correct level of rigor. And so if you look at what the teachers recommended seven years ago, they also recommended lower cut score then we pushed it up Pearson is saying if you want to keep it at that higher level fine but and and I and I will you know even as I've pushed for a slightly number above articulation I can go into that again if you need but I won't what what's important to note is the teachers are clearly saying that we put it up too high last time it probably needs to come back and I'm saying well

[01:51:55] not that far and and there was there were some comments yesterday such around maybe that one person shouldn't make this decision it's important for you know that we debate this as a department. Shelly and I sit down, Sarah's there, team is there.

[01:52:11] We look at this together and understand that articulation is also making a policy decision because they're getting that impact data. So to us, we see it as indicating a range at which that rigor might be when you think about median. And we are saying that with what we've seen with NAEP and everything else, we probably shouldn't go too far back.

[01:52:36] - I'm sorry, Dr. Paxton. the with the uh psychometricians work cut score for new tests they're looking they're looking at a new test they're looking at new content right compared to the previous and then determining what the equivalent level of rigor would be so that's that that that's the difference there i don't know if that helps and that helps me as far as understanding that they're looking at here's content a rigor is this here's content b with the same rigor b right um so when you made the statement about you give the example of the fifth and sixth grade scenario excuse me

[01:53:15] and you said the articulation committee will if they're looking at the impact data and they're trying to interpret uh how maybe content there might be content explanation for the impact data being what it what it is can you can you give an example of what kind of content explanation they might deduce because to me it ties back to some of the previous discussions that the individual committees had they're already looking at they're looking at content they're taking into consideration the rigor of the content and then they're making a call on what the median proficient it so I guess I'm trying

[01:53:53] to understand what would they discover about the content at that point that has not already been considered as part of the process what's an example so an An example might be, suppose there is some new content in grade 6 reading standards this time around that wasn't there before.

[01:54:12] So we might, the articulation committee might say, well, because we have this new content, we would expect the pass rate to be slightly lower in grade 6 than in grade 5.

[01:54:28] Sometimes the comment is, this is new content that is being introduced for the first time. So I think the difference in what the articulation committee does and the individual committees is the individual committees don't see that impact data.

[01:54:49] So they don't know that there might be a difference in what -- how it affects the pass rates, whereas the articulation committee does have that information. And so our process, again, in honoring the expertise of teachers, ask them, if you see a difference, can you explain it in content?

[01:55:14] And the round -- the individual committees are going question by question. Are the articulation committees doing the same? No. So to my point, then, the individual committees, these expert teachers that we've validated, going question by question hopefully relating that question to the content that they're going to be related to responsible for teaching so you would think part of their deduction is based on the content we've taught we feel like this is the score whereas the articulation committee is not looking at question by question but yet they're having to potentially use one example of content

[01:55:50] explanation when they're not even looking at you see i'm just i'm just struggling to connect that dot to where they're better qualified to make those deductions when they haven't looked at the information. I think that's why we have three committee members from each individual committee there. So, you know, we might see that the projected pass rate, you know, in grade six is much lower than what

the projected pass rate in grade five is. And so, then the grade five committee members and the grade six committee members will talk about what the differences might be.

[01:56:28] So while it is an overall committee, when there's a question about two specific tests and the differences, we are relying on the experts from those individual committees. Okay. I forgot that they're still part of that. Okay.

[01:56:43] Yeah. Then one last question. When there is such a large variance like that in grade three, as far as what the round three median in the Articulation Committee, are those factors of that differentiating decisions, how are those captured and evaluated to understand? I'm just trying to say, how do we capture that? Round three said 16, Articulation said 21. That's quite a spread. Why? Like, what's creating that variance? You know, are you privy to that? Then when you're making your decision, I'm saying, you know, how do we reconcile that difference?

[01:57:23] Well, so just like those teachers probably use the bias of what they know in their classroom, right, they know what they think kids can do generally as they go question by question through. When they get to articulation, they know that when they look at their classroom or their school or their county, that it would be unreasonable to say that 98% of kids could pass a test.

[01:57:48] And I'm not saying that was one of the factors that they considered. articulations of making a policy decision on what they think that appropriate benchmark is based on the evidence that they have around the students that might need extra support. And I think that's how I think about it too. You know, that if the board were to set a cut score that was so low that every student was passing it, I don't think we'd be moving our rigor forward such that we could perform on NAEP and be competitive as we have claimed to be one of the top educated states. And I also fear that we would be under-identifying students that need extra support. And they make, you know, failure on the SOL is a determining factor for kids

[01:58:27] getting remediation extra opportunities to learn. And if I might add a comment, I think we have to remember that our teachers were in these committees following a slight drop in reading scores across the state. And when you think about teachers reviewing individual items and perhaps having a difficult time determining whether or not a student who was just proficient would get it correct I think you can

[01:59:03] see that sometimes the the discussion is such that um people err on the side of saying no the student won't get it correct and they don't have the individual committees don't have the benefit of seeing what that would do to the pass rate and often when the individual committee members are sitting in articulation and they see what the round three recommendation would mean, they do have an aha moment. And sometimes they're some of the strongest advocates to move the cut

[01:59:40] score up, if that helps Dr. Paxton. It does. It's just interesting that they all, almost all of them had some kind of aha moment, but there was like one tick or two ticks of an aha. Whereas at the third grade level, it was like, aha, like, you know, it was a lot bigger. So I was, you know, because all what you just explained, I totally understand, and that happened at every grade level. But at the third grade level, it happened more significantly. And I would say if you go back to the 2013 decision, they moved grade three further than everything else. So it had more room,

[02:00:15] I think to come back. But from a department standpoint, when we think about this as a team and we're making those same type of policy decisions as articulation, I think it's important for you to know

we were not willing to go too far from articulation because we do trust the teachers that are in the room. We do have great content reviewers. And so, like I said, But we view their recommendation as the middle of a range.

[02:00:48] And so we think of ourselves as being on the upper end of the range that they were bringing to you. Dr. Mann. Yes. First of all, I thank you for such a very detailed overview of a process that is really important for us to understand.

[02:01:07] And I say that because one of the great things about what Virginia is proud of is that it It is a state that aspires to see all students succeed, and setting the bar for that is important. And as I've tried to process and think through this and the decision that the board will ultimately be asked to make, it's really trying to sort of balance this policy dynamic with protecting the integrity of what proficiency means

[02:01:42] from a reliable, valid perspective, which the psychometric angle invites us to consider. So I make that as a statement, as just a part of what is a tension in this that we're having to wrestle with. I didn't ask this question yesterday, but I would like to appreciate a bit what about our approach? We say we use a modified NGF procedure. What element of our approach makes it modified? It would just be helpful for me to understand that.

[02:02:25] It really is the way in which teachers respond to the items. So we use what is actually called the yes-no method. And so when, as I explained to you, teachers review the items, they think about that just proficient student and they think about whether that just proficient student would get the item correct two out of three times, which is really the definition of most.

[02:02:56] And then they answer yes or no. There are some other versions of Angoff where the teachers would estimate what percentage of barely proficient students would get the item correct.

[02:03:13] So to be really technical, we use the yes/no Enghoff method. Does that help? The Enghoff method is one of the oldest standard setting methodologies, and it is the one that we've used some version in Virginia since the original standard setting in 1998.

[02:03:37] Dr. Pexton? Do we know how that compares to what other states use for this process? There are states who use different methods. It is important for you to understand that many and perhaps most states do not set their cut scores until after the tests are administered.

[02:04:04] We have never done that in Virginia because there would be little appetite for not having scores available until sometime next fall. so um we are unusual in that you you set the cut scores ahead of testing so that when students test we know the expectations um there are many other methodologies um some places

[02:04:37] order the items in uh in order of difficulty and have teachers pick the item where they think students should, the last item, they think students should get correct to be proficient.

[02:04:53] So there are many other methodologies. I think probably the most important difference in Virginia is that you do this ahead of time so people are not having to wait for scores. And that is something that the 1998 board actually decided was important. And if I may, Mr. Gecker, I've been here the whole time, and I do fully appreciate the methodology that this board

[02:05:26] uses, and I think the fact that you adopt the cut scores so that people are not having to wait for scores is certainly very admirable. Ms. Atkins? Just a little more context to Virginia.

[02:05:44] When we started down this journey, Common Core was not in place. So we were really, as a state, leading sort of this kind of vision of instituting standardized tasks in the core content areas.

[02:06:05] I understand, Dr. Lane, of yesterday. That wasn't meant to be funny. I'm just trying to piece this together. It's difficult for those of us who aren't engaged in the field the way some of you are.

[02:06:23] I think the logic of the argument is that if we increase rigor, we will increase basically what's taught. If you increase the rigor of the assessment, then that will translate back to teaching to that rigor in the classroom.

[02:06:39] Is that right? I think one thing that's important to remember, and I think Ms. Atkinson mentioned this yesterday, is the standards of learning test have to be based on the standards. And so often when the rigor changes, it is because of a change in the rigor of the standards, not so much the rigor of the test.

[02:07:03] But as you adopt cut scores, that does imply a level of rigor that's implied to be proficient. a higher cut score then there's a belief that and i guess data to demonstrate that there will be some educational improvement in the classroom as teachers basically teach to the higher rigor and i think there is a experience with the standards of learning test would tell us that there's a a balance there um we certainly have seen um situations where the the tests

[02:07:37] themselves and the expectations have probably resulted in a different kind of teaching in virginia you know when these were put into place in 1998 i don't think anyone ever thought that we would end up with students passing them at the level they did but as dr lane mentioned um when the the cut scores were adopted in 2013 since that time we have not really seen

[02:08:11] an increase in the reading pass rates over time typically we see such an increase so that might suggest that you might not want to maintain exactly the same level of rigor this time around separate out for a minute the pass rates from what we're teaching. Is what we're teaching changing in response to the setting of the cut score? In other words, again, if we have the higher cut scores, I think part of this theory is that we will see increased achievement, you know, by what we're actually teaching

[02:08:50] as opposed to just how many are passing. And Dr. Lane may want to weigh in here. Well, I probably just misunderstand what he's saying, so I'm happy to have him tell me again. it's the part of this that you know i still i uh and that actually frankly makes a little bit of sense to me that if we you know it's a big system and everybody responds to you know the the goals of the system if the goal of the system has a harder assessment at the end there may be more effort to teach and i don't mean teach to the test in the way it's used negatively but to teach

[02:09:27] uh in a fashion that allows for you know students to pass a more rigorous meaning a you know we We know a little bit more for the minimally proficient child, knows a little bit more than they would have, perhaps, if the assessment cut score were set a little bit lower.

[02:09:44] And I say that, honestly, believing that's not a bad thing. It's, I think, part of the argument for raising it. And as Dr. Wilson mentioned yesterday, we did have a significant change in the level of rigor with the last set of standards in the last test, where the focus really now is more on on critical thinking so i think the the test doesn't necessarily change perhaps what is taught but i i think it does maybe change the emphasis exactly okay yeah i'll clarify my point

[02:10:22] there i i think that the standards drive what is taught and i believe that uh local curriculum maybe even drives how it's taught and but i believe that this cut score policy decision you know if you set the cut score too high and you had to remediate 40 percent of students you are missing the ability to tailor your resources narrowly enough to really make a difference with kids but if you cut set the cut score such that you're maybe remediating 20 or 30 percent of students you can really tailor your resources so what i think the cut score drives is the tier two

[02:10:59] interventions and the extra supports that students receive and what you have to balance is you don't want to be offering that service to too many kids and you also don't want to be offering that service to too few and that is what we weigh as we think about this range uh that articulation and the teachers recommend to us okay we'll debate next time for the final whether it's good policy to decide what we set this at based upon how many kids get remediation all right it's a resource issue. But I guess... And that's not the only reason. It's not going to be singular.

[02:11:34] Like I said, I'm not going to debate that one today. That's a later day topic. But as a board, we are talking about really reducing the number of SOLs and replacing them, or the assessments, not the standards themselves, but the assessments, and replacing them with performance-based assessments. And are we, when we do that, if the belief is that these tests by increasing rigor improve in some way academic achievement. Do we actually believe

[02:12:08] that removing these tests and replacing them with things like performance-based assessments is going to reduce that rigor in the classroom? So, no. But what I... So, if that's right, then how do we get to the point where we can set this score at the right place, meaning what a minimally proficient third grader should know, and still entice teachers to do to teach that level of rigor that we believe appropriate for a minimally proficient third grader and and what i would say is and you ask a lot of yes or no questions and it's important

[02:12:44] for us to provide easier that way provide right but but these are not yes or no matters there's not one reason that we set the cut score there are dozens of reasons that we look at across curriculum, across remediation, across policy, across what we know anecdotally about student performance. And so when you bring performance assessment into it, the intent of performance assessment is to encourage a different type of instruction that doesn't focus only on knowledge and understanding as a multiple choice does. Performance assessment is being developed so

[02:13:21] that we can create the critical thinking that the collaboration the the creativity that we want in the classroom and that might sacrifice whether a kid can answer multiple choice because you're focusing on these deeper skills that we feel like are more important and we may have been wrong over time that answering multiple choice questions is the best way to educate a student in terms of assessing their outcomes and so i don't think it's fair to compare what we're doing here but i I will say that until such time as we believe that we can psychometrically determine achievement

[02:13:56] of students under federal law, we have to maintain a process that we can ascertain and guarantee consistency and quality across all the question types that we ask. I said this is probably not the time to have this discussion, but it is going to have to be a discussion we have because, I mean, the answer, I understand we're required to do it's 17 of the SOLs. But, you know, sort of the underlying, it seems to me like we merge too much

[02:14:35] the assessment into what we're teaching and placing more importance, in a sense, on the assessment than upon what's actually going on. And what I heard you just say, and probably incorrectly, is that, you know, maybe teaching kids how to answer multiple choice questions is not the best for their long-term outcomes. And yet here we are, you know, promoting that and saying we're going to actually make it harder to answer these multiple choice questions.

[02:15:03] And if it's not the right way, then we ought to be advocating much more seriously for the other way than we have been. And I believe we've been advocating for that. There have certainly been prohibitions that have kept us from moving forward.

[02:15:18] I know I get that. I know it's under our control at this point. But I'll also say that this broader debate of what these tests should look like, we are more than ready to have as a department with not only the board, anyone, but these seven assessments you're talking about today are seven of the required seven.

[02:15:36] Right. Okay. Anybody else? Dr. Mann. Mr. President, I do appreciate the conversation, and I do think it's important to note that focus on rigor as a very important element of both assessment and teaching, because assessments are consequential. And I think we heard students today speak to that, especially in districts

[02:16:13] where the resources or the educators available to ensure that all children actually have access to teachers that are going to help get at what I'm hearing as an undercurrent of why it's so important to have the policy element, a component of sort of where we land.

[02:16:35] It's very difficult to sit with that when we know what we know about the inequities of all children having access to qualify well-prepared educators.

[02:16:53] And so I just feel compelled to state that that element of this has to be true if we have to embrace that perspective that I'm hearing from the superintendent as an important in consideration in setting these scores.

[02:17:14] - And I think it's important to note that the debate that we're having is not whether the previous rigor was too high, because we agree with the articulation on that. It's a factor of how far too high was it and how much lower do you want to take it.

[02:17:30] And I think in the context of our declining NAEP scores, we have to be really careful about that. - Yes. - You know, looking back and maybe there's an advantage for me sitting here for eight years, but looking back, what i know is that when we set a set when we have a new test come out and we set our scores and we see declines in the scores as a result but typically we see them increase over time under the old system and i'm going to go back to when we used to have more people coming in and

[02:18:07] talking to us about uh why they needed a plan and and what there was that they in their analysis they had not been with fidelity implementing the new standards that we had put in place and so there is some value to the assessment and setting the scores because if if we truly believe the standards that we adopted not the assessments but the standards are the are what we believe learning

[02:18:43] expectations for all our students it's there is a mechanism it's part of a mechanism to ensure that those standards are implemented with fidelity and um and i appreciate your comment but a lot of that i mean we do have concerns about the the experiences of teachers sitting before our students especially

our students who are at risk but until we can figure out how to make that change if that's not not in our board's control that is our localities it is the localities that

[02:19:23] do that kind of development. It's they who figure out, and they do figure it out. I mean, they do work at figuring it out, but it is a process. And so I just think there's, as Dr.

[02:19:40] Lane said, it is complicated, and there's a lot of factors that flow from this. But I think for me, it is, you know, I truly believe in those standards, the standards themselves, the learning expectations and i really want to ensure that those are what our schools are implementing with fidelity okay i'm sure you'll be happy to hear this we are glad to accept this on first review thank you very much i appreciate it all right we are going to take a quick break we'll be back at

[02:20:13] 11 20. thanks uh you don't need to take your seats but maintain an appropriate level of quiet would

[02:34:01] be great uh we're back in session item g first review of the proposed revisions to regulations governing secondary school transcripts good morning good morning president gecker vice president atkinson board members and dr lane i'm assistant superintendent dr samantha hollins for the department of special education student services very pleased to be with you today for your first review are the proposed revisions to the regulations governing secondary school transcripts you all will have remembered this item from back in july when you approved

[02:34:37] the notice for intent for rule making the last approved version by the board was completed in 2007 however there have been subsequent updates to this information including a may 2016 amendment as well as a superintendent's memo that was issued in may of 2018 to provide additional specification on specific transcript elements including absence school attended and listed coursework in front of you you'll see the draft that has all of the information from a very robust engagement strategy with stakeholders that we had representing nine institutes of higher education local school division participation parents the virginia community college system as well

[02:35:16] as a state council for higher education in virginia this document reflects changes in professional practice at those post-secondary institutions including business and industry necessitated necessitate necessitated revisions to this document as you can tell it's been a little while since we've done a full revision. However, there has been a lot of communication coming from the field on this issue, so it was a great opportunity for us to gather that together and to provide it to you today for first review. This revision does support the Virginia profile of a graduate as well as Priority 3 of the comprehensive plan and focuses on developing knowledge, skills, and competencies and experiences for students

[02:35:56] during their K-12 education to make them life-ready and be on a path to to successful citizenship and participation in the evolving economy the superintendent of public instruction recommends the board of education receive for first review the proposed revisions to the regulations governing secondary school transcripts and i'll pause and be happy to answer any questions or take any questions of the board that would be me okay there we go i just have a couple of questions under definitions for the verified unit of credit it refers to other tests is approved by the department it's actually those

[02:36:34] substitute tests are approved by the board thank you so much mrs. Atkinson we are going to update that definition to accurately reflect the standards of accreditation language that was the purpose

and changing it in the first place so we'll have a revised copy of that update for your review and I have um another question under um 8 vac 2160 30. it's under format and this is just a question because i i don't know it's number 17 it says a list of verified credits earned including any credits earned by substitution what does that mean that includes verified credits that were earned by

[02:37:10] taking a substitute assessment okay but it's still a verified credit that's true okay because it fits the definition of verified credit okay and then just one more question number 24 I think yeah you changed the provision that relates to showing SAT and ACT from opt-out to opt-in can you talk to me a little bit about the policy context for that that change I can that came as a result of really robust

[02:37:48] conversation particularly with institutes of higher education that's reflective of a growing trend across the country with what college applications are seeking from students additional reason is that more and more colleges and universities are providing test optional admissions thus putting the test scores on a transcript when a student may be applying through a test optional application could be detrimental to the students so we've actually seen the field swing pretty dramatically to more opt-in procedures because the status quo for college admissions has been to not have those standardized test scores reported on the admission information. And have we gotten any feedback about what that might impact the local school

[02:38:28] divisions related to getting that information out to families that in order to get it out to get those scores on you know let's say you're applying to a college that hasn't gone that route you know right now you would have assumed those test scores would have gone so have we gotten any feedback from localities about the impact this might have on on them absolutely they see this as a continuing point of education for parents and families particularly with students we surveyed a list of institutes of higher education and all 35 of the folks that were on our list said that they have

[02:39:06] test optional so while students and parents first come into contact with this information and their admissions information school counselors will now have updated information to share with families as well as some articulation because many of the institutes of higher ed that we spoke with have differing reporting structure so meaning the difference between SAT or ACT while as before was a key pivot point for admission now is much more apt to be utilized for student placement for getting contextual information about a student's entry point into secondary education thank you one point that I would offer to help with that is

[02:39:42] atkinson is in that item 24 the language is actually now permissive for local divisions to set this policy whereas before they had to do so this gives locals local divisions a little bit of flexibility on what they what their parents and what their communities are asking them to do it does dr wilson we feel that that based on the feedback we've gotten from local school divisions is a great option for them to be able to articulate and design a policy that's reflective of their community.

[02:40:13] Okay. The Board will accept this for first review. Thank you. Thank you. All right. Item H, first review of the proposed revisions to the suicide prevention guidelines. Great. So the second item that we have for your review today are the proposed revisions to the suicide prevention guidelines.

[02:40:34] This information was last revised in 2003, and the Board of Education is required to develop guidelines for licensed school personnel to use in contacting parents or if conditions warrant the local or state service agency when they believe a student is at imminent risk for suicide.

[02:40:50] This is the result of ongoing work that the department has had with a variety of other state agency participants as well as the governor's office in particular. In October 2018, the Governor's Children's Cabinet Student Safety Workgroup recommended that DOE update and disseminate the suicide prevention guidelines to all school divisions in a timely manner in collaboration with the Virginia Department of Health, the Virginia Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services, as well as the Virginia Center for School and Campus Safety.

[02:41:17] The revised guidelines incorporate the recommendations made by the Governor's Children's Cabinet. They reflect current research and align with partner state agency efforts. We've also updated the online resources that are available on the VDOE website to really align very closely with these proposed regulations.

[02:41:34] I think the most exciting thing is that you'll look in the format. It's really a redesign to make this document more accessible for individuals who don't do this work day in and day out. Not only is it something that our school service and specialized instructional support personnel are very excited about, but in particular, this document creates an access point for families, students, and community agencies and stakeholders who obviously, given some of the comments we heard today, are very interested in this topic.

[02:42:02] One thing we did want to clarify, because there has been so many changes related to this document related to this platform there have been some really significant changes within the 1999 changes as well as the 2003 so we've been able to provide a table for your reference here to make sure you can track all those changes and see where they landed in the new document that new format is great but if you're used to looking at the previous one this will create a nice bridge for your understanding so just a small note because we did have so much interagency collaboration with this these guidelines are meant to serve in conjunction with the threat assessment in

[02:42:38] Virginia public schools model policies procedures and guidelines and are attended to offer additional direction to school threat assessment teams when addressing threats to self model policies and best practices for Virginia school divisions were developed in the effort to protect the health and well-being of all Virginia students by helping school divisions develop procedures to effectively prevent assess the risk of intervene and and follow up with students the proposed regulations support the priorities of the board particularly as priority one of the Board of Education's comprehensive plan.

[02:43:10] The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education receive for first review the proposed revisions to the suicide prevention guidelines. I'll pause there. I'm happy to answer any questions or comments. Any questions or comments? So we'll take that on first review also. Item High. Great. All right. Last but certainly not least, first review of revisions to the Family Life Education Board of Education guidelines and standards of learning for Virginia public schools this set of standards has

[02:43:48] been updated in pieces and parts resulting in legislation from both the 2018 and 2019 Virginia General Assembly session we've articulated each of those legislative options within the report and provided context for how they've been incorporated into the standards I want to be really clear at this juncture that that has really been the only significant addition and revision to the standards as they exist currently we are excited to announce that we'll be holding public hearings on this topic around the

Commonwealth and we know that the board members will join us in participating in those but obviously this is a great opportunity to hear back from folks at local school division

[02:44:25] level parents and community members as you can see this is a an item that comes up very regularly with legislative action but also is a topic that many of our school divisions parents and students speak actively on the proposed Those revisions that you see in front of you align the guidelines with both of those years of legislative changes, and a stakeholder group comprised of family life educators from a geographically diverse group of school divisions, family life education trainers, and a human trafficking nonprofit prevention group in Virginia was convened to review an initial draft of these proposed revisions for your review.

[02:44:59] They were able to provide significant input and feedback and give us some thoughts for how this could play out over the next few months of intense review. Family life education experts as well as current family life education curriculum worked to embed the new content into the relevant standards and the team was very deliberate when inserting content into certain grade levels and when including age appropriate elements.

[02:45:22] The proposed revisions to the family life education board of education guidelines and standards of learning for Virginia public schools support the goals and priorities of the board of education of providing a high quality effective learning environment for all students as outlined in priority one. And I want to say this was a great opportunity for us to work collaboratively with the Department of Instruction here.

[02:45:40] But I'm also joined by Joe Worf, who's a member of my staff, Maribel Symera and Martha Montgomery. Really a dream team for all three of these items, but will be joining me on the road as we hold the public hearing. So with that, I will pause and I'm happy to answer any questions or take any comments.

[02:45:56] Ms. Hulton. Thank you. have a question on page 10 section 2a lists the local programs shall be comprehensive and sequential and showing shall include the following content areas and then there's a long list the amendment to the I think it's item 16

[02:46:29] dating violence took out some of the language about consent and I see that the consent language is elsewhere in the standards, but I believe I understand correctly that the meaning of consent, the nature of consent, what is consent to sexual activity is a required element now, right? Legislatively mandated element.

[02:46:56] That's true, Mrs. Holton. In 2017, the General Assembly created legislation to permit it. However, in 2019, that was changed to required. Permissive change to required. I think this is not intentional, but I think that list should include consent so the consent language in paragraph 16 dating violence used to used to include the optional consent language and it came out and it should come out because it's no longer optional but then there should be an added item number 18 or somewhere else in the list the consent to the meaning thereof and if it's there and I'm missing it I'd be happy to have that pointed out to me but

[02:47:36] I don't see it well and we're happy to follow up but there's also additional information around consent reflective of the both of those legislative pieces on page three and four of that document so but in terms of telling the localities the topics that they must cover you know you could say that it's somewhere

as part of the human sexuality discussion or the dating violence discussion but I think it needs to be explicit that consent is one of the topics you must include in your program we'll be happy to take a look at that thank you thank

[02:48:10] you and again as i say if it's there and i'm missing it you can let me know ms atkinson um this is really a comment and not related to the this at all but when we when i was one for the health uh standards um i got comments about the family life and specifically about that new requirement that relates to female genitalia um and concerns by the folks in the field as to how to teach that because they're not finding resources on that topic at all and so i would just like to

[02:48:51] highlight highlight that because i think it's a sensitive topic and they are looking for you know material but are not finding material so thank you that's important feedback for us to hear dr man thank you i just have one quick question about um this is on page 14 and it just refers to the k3 um the language that's embedded and just trying to appreciate uh personal privacy versus privacy i mean developmentally i was just trying to make sense of the distinction and i wonder if

[02:49:31] there was any insight you could share on that yes so the one general comment that i'll make about that is that personal privacy was contained in the legislative changes that were made between 2017 in 2019. So that's depicted to have an actual reflection of the legislative piece that was passed. And if I'm not mistaken, off the top of my head, it related closely to when we're talking about securing electronic devices and the communication sensitive in nature that could be shared across students. But I will clarify that and make sure that we get a more robust explanation for those terms and how they're utilized throughout the document.

[02:50:05] That would be helpful. Anybody else? If not, we will accept for first review item I. Thank you very much. thank you so much item j those revisions to the fine arts standards of learning good morning morning president gecker vice president atkinson members of the board and dr lane

[02:50:41] i'm honored to present to you today for first review the proposed 2020 fine arts standards of learning the fine arts standards include dance arts music theater arts and visual arts i would like to acknowledge douglas armstrong fine arts music specialist for his contributions during this process, as well as Andrew Watson, Tara Taylor, JR Snow, our three content consultants, and Kristonya Brown, our coordinator of history and social science here at the Department of Education, Vanessa Wiggand, the specialist for health and PE, and Jessica Costa, a specialist for English language learning.

[02:51:17] I would also like to acknowledge the support of Dr. James Lane, Mr. Donald Fairheart, Mr. Michael Bowling, Dr. Tina Maglemot, and Dr. Christine Harris for contributions and guidance. most importantly i would like to acknowledge the hard work concerted efforts and valuable contributions of teachers and curriculum specialists who served on one of the four standards of learning review committees for dance arts music theater arts and visual arts lastly i'd like to acknowledge the valuable feedback provided by our external review panel

[02:51:51] that represented institutions of higher education professional organizations museum partners and and partners from community arts organizations. On March 21st, 2019, the board approved the timeline to proceed with the review process for Fine Arts Standards of Learning.

[02:52:11] In accordance with the plan, the Department of Education took the following steps to produce the drafts of the proposed revised Fine Arts Standards of Learning that are being presented today. First,

public comment was received via four email boxes, one for each discipline.

[02:52:28] A brief summary of comments is in the boilerplate. Second, we solicited and convened separate groups of teachers, administrators, and curriculum specialists for each of the four fine arts disciplines to review public comment and consider proposed revisions.

[02:52:43] Teachers were present from each of the eight superintendents regions and represented a variety of classroom settings, including English language learner inclusion, special education inclusion, and gifted learners. Teachers represented urban, rural, and suburban settings.

[02:53:02] The Fine Arts Standards of Learning review committees took into consideration national core art standards, advanced placement and international baccalaureate requirements, as well as frameworks for culturally responsive pedagogy.

[02:53:18] Additionally, a group of external stakeholders representing institutions of higher education, professional organizations, museum partners, and partners from community arts organizations convened on October 23rd, 2019, to review the proposed changes for clarity, rigor, accuracy of content, and consistency. Among all groups, there were deep discussions about pedagogy, best practice, and the future of fine arts. At the end of this process, teams had mutual respect for one another and a positive outlook for the process, the work produced, and the future of fine arts

[02:53:56] programs in the Commonwealth. From the onset of the process, three goals were established for the review. The first being alignment of the proposed standards to the profile of a Virginia graduate, specifically the five Cs. Fine arts teachers and leaders found skills for creative thinking, critical thinking, communication, collaboration, and citizenship to be a natural fit for fine arts programs. Focus on the five Cs includes additional support for implementation of fine arts skills and processes as they apply to college opportunities,

[02:54:34] career options, and 21st century workplace skills. Second, in our review of standards, there's been an intentional focus on including culturally responsive language and practices. The fine arts standard seeks to maximize the potential of all learners and are respectful of diverse backgrounds and experiences of Virginia's public school students.

[02:54:59] Fine arts teachers and leaders across the Commonwealth are carefully considering issues of diversity, equity, and inclusion in instructional planning. Third, the proposed revised standards include opportunities for students to explore the impact and use of current and emerging technologies that are innovating creative fields.

[02:55:21] There's also a focus on building connections between disciplines so that students develop flexible thinking, fluency, and problem solving skills as future ready thinkers and learners. Based on feedback from educators and our external panel, there are three key changes that will be immediately noticeable as you review the documents.

[02:55:42] First, updates have been made to the strands and structure of the standards, which I'll explain in a moment. Second, in the 2013 standards, guitar had individual sets of standards for three levels of instruction. We are proposing that guitar standards are now incorporated within instrumental music standards at all seven levels of instrumental instruction.

[02:56:05] This change will support the expansion of guitar instruction and opportunities. Third, the proposed revised standards include new standards for theater arts K through five, dance arts K through five, and two more levels of dance arts in middle school.

[02:56:21] The driving reason for this change is to support teachers and schools engaging in standards-based arts integration. The addition of standards at these levels supports authentic connections between the arts and other disciplines and helps prepare dance and theater educators as they're already endorsed in instruction pre-K through 12.

[02:56:45] In order to meet the goals of this revision, standards have been updated with a clear structure that provides consistency clarity and scaffolding of concepts the structure starts with our proposed revised strands creative process focuses on the creative thinking skills that guide the development of original work in fine arts communication and critical thinking contain standards that help students to analyze interpret evaluate and evaluate the work of self and others as well as build communication skills for fine arts processes

[02:57:18] and products history culture and citizenship focus on the historical and cultural influences of fine arts as well as the engagement with fine arts as a community member innovation in the arts provides opportunities for students to develop connections between the present and future as they explore evolving career college and workplace connections as well as an understanding of the impact of new and emerging technologies on the field and develop problem-solving skills through cross-curricular connections. Technique and application focuses on the technical knowledge

[02:57:56] needed for students to excel in the particular discipline. Our students are prepared to compete at the highest levels for career and college opportunities in fine arts. Within each strand, each standard is vertically and horizontally aligned from grades kindergarten through the levels of high school instruction. They're also aligned across the four disciplines of fine arts.

[02:58:21] this slide represents the main ideas that each set of fine art standards focuses on for example standard number one in all disciplines at all levels will focus on creative thinking in the in the development of an original product and standard two will focus on the application of a creative process within the critical thinking and communication strand there are standards three four and five which all serve the overall concept it is the same for history culture and citizenship as well as innovation in the arts. The standards under technique and application vary

[02:58:56] by discipline and by number and represent the essential skills and knowledge of the discipline. Once the standards are approved, we will be able to place the standards within a chart that can be used as a resource for teachers of each content area that demonstrate the progression of skills and concepts from early to later levels of instruction and can be used as a tool for teachers for the sequencing and aligning of skills we did bring a sample of the chart that we're mentioning if you should not hold it up if you would like to see it we'd be happy to pass it around but this is the resource we're

[02:59:30] developing for teachers which I'd like us to pass it initial feedback from teachers during the summer review committees on the direction of the proposed revised standards has been positive here are a few comments that teachers and fine arts curriculum specialists said at the conclusion of summer review committees. These changes value student-driven work that focuses on process and reflection. They promote student voice in creation. They aim to be inclusive of all people, communities,

[03:00:04] and perspectives. And these are forward-thinking standards that have merged the best work of the 2013 standards with emerging trends in arts education. Here are some additional comments from teachers on review committees, including we are increasing student agency and voice. If the board accepts these standards today for a first review, the department will post a superintendent's memorandum tomorrow announcing a one-month public comment period and hearings in February. Thank you

[03:00:42] for your willingness to assist with public hearings. The approved review and revision timeline calls for the adoption of the fine arts standards of learning by March 2020. In closing, the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education accept for first review the proposed revised fine art standards of learning.

[03:01:05] And I'll be happy to respond to any questions at this time. - Okay, thank you. Dr. Duran. - No question, just wanna comment. And first of all, thank both of you for your leadership in this work. It's very exciting to see all of the changes, but two in particular that I'm very excited about is the inclusive language and the focus on supporting equity and cultural diversity and how we can make sure that all of our students are a part of the arts education.

[03:01:29] So thank you for that. And also the inclusion of the elementary standards of K-5 and K-7-8 as well for the dance. I think that's going to be valuable for our elementary educators to feel and to see how important it is. But also to our administrators to understand that arts education is an area that we need to pay much attention to in our standards.

[03:01:51] And it is a part of our, as you indicated here, five C's. So it doesn't just go a long way for the teachers, so I think there's many benefits to that, but also for the greater community to understand the value of having standards for this at the elementary level. So thank you for that. And of course, a personal thank you and point of privilege to Tara Taylor for your work on this as well, from Fairfax.

[03:02:11] Thank you. Please, Dr. Wilson. Thank you very much. Can you talk a little bit, and maybe I've overlooked it in the materials, One of the folks who spoke at public comment mentioned arts integration and this notion of how we weave all of the pieces together or find opportunities to do that.

[03:02:35] So I'm just wondering, as the group has put together the standards and thinking about next steps, can you talk a little bit about what you already do to ensure arts integration and then how these standards lend themselves to that continued work?

[03:02:50] Absolutely. One of the several reasons that we have for wanting the standards at the elementary level is because we know that teachers in the commonwealth are engaging in arts integration and we want there to be an authentic connection to standards of learning to support the authentic instruction in both areas that are being integrated.

[03:03:09] We have a plan moving forward for how to develop resources to support the implementation of the fine arts standards and those resources would certainly be available to teachers of content areas to see examples of how fine arts instruction can be integrated in a classroom setting and that that plan for resources will certainly include all areas of the Commonwealth and hopefully developing a plan for equitable distribution of those resources anybody else thank you very much for the

[03:03:43] presentation we'll see you in March and board accepts us for first review okay item k first review of the uh virginia's four-year perkins five state plan yeah it's unopened good

[03:04:17] morning morning president gecker vice president atkinson members of the board and dr lane superintendent of public instruction we are pleased to present for first review the application for continuation of funding to support career and technical education pursuant to the strengthening career and technical education for the 21st century act the code of for virginia 22.1-227

[03:04:57] and the virginia administrative code 8 vac 20 120-10 designates the authority to carry out the act to the board of uh to the board of education in carrying that act out the board is also recognized as the state board of career and technical education and as such has the responsibility department of education the department of corrections the department of of juvenile justice

[03:05:37] and the Virginia Community College System. Joining me are our colleagues, David Escheman, Bill Patch, and Joseph Ryder from DOE, and also from the CCS, Todd Esty and John Mahoney.

[03:06:01] The timeline for submitting the application to the U.S. Department of Education and the U.S. Department of Labor includes several key actions. Those actions are outlined in 10 key milestones. And I would back up here in speaking to both the Department of Education and the

[03:06:34] Department of Labor in that during Governor McCullough's term all state agencies were merged in terms of workforce development and submitting a plan to the Department of Labor. So we are actually working simultaneously in that the plan will be submitted to the Weola portal and to the U.S. Department of Education's portal. A couple of key dates that we should mention because of the

[03:07:14] importance of that in the actual act. September 17th, a meeting was held with the governor's staff, and the purpose of that meeting was to coordinate the work and outline the actions that take place.

[03:07:33] the act itself requires that the governor's office be central to the development of this entire effort on september the 23rd a key stakeholders group was held of governor staff business and industry from the from across the state and and educators on september 30th a meeting was held between secondary and post-secondary for the purpose of discussing the local distribution

[03:08:05] formula of funds and the performance in the indicators then on october 15 16 23 and 24 statewide public hearings were convened in williamsburg prince williams county harrison bird and with the members of of your cte advisory committee assisted in in those meetings on pages two through six of the application you will find the summary of the public comment and

[03:08:43] then on pages 147 through 149 you will find the court stenographer's transcript of the actual comments provided by each person today is milestone six the first review by the board other actions that must occur prior to the submission of the plan to to the department of labor in april or on april 1 and to the department of education by no later than april 15th includes

[03:09:21] an additional 60-day public comment period and a 30-day review period by the governor's office and we're working simultaneously with the governor's staff and the submission of the weola plan to accomplish those uh dates uh there are several uh key yes just to add one piece to it sure and that uh will you explain the the next phase after this plan is created how we'll go into the like the program level review and uh and and how the money will be spent not just how it's

[03:10:00] how it's divvied up yes there are several key pieces are opportunities that are a part of perkins five and i'll mention just a couple of those one the act expands the use of funds from what was in previous acts at grades 7 through 12 to grades 5 through 12. The act does require that

[03:10:32] school divisions conduct a comprehensive local local needs assessment every two years. There's greater opportunity for work-based learning experiences, keen focus on equity and special populations uh industry recognized cred credentials and a continued emphasis on on the development of

[03:11:01] rigorous and relevant in in instructional material this school school year for virginia received 28 million three hundred ten thousand four hundred and ninety four dollars the act requires that those funds be divided initially on the basis of 85 percent of the funds are driven to the local formula that's the hundred and hundred and thirty two school school divisions and the 23 colleges

[03:11:39] then 10 percent of the funds are used for state leadership activities and five percent for administration and we'll come come back to to those uh slides a couple of key action items that the board may want to spend some time over the next month or two in review would be one the local distribution formula the act requires that there be discussion about that second there when

[03:12:16] as the act was being promulgated through congress the national governance association really spent time focusing on the notion of a reserve fund uh reserve funds have been utilized in previous acts but to date not in the commonwealth so we have looked at and with staff in the governor's office

[03:12:46] at what if the state established a reserve fund and then the act requires that the state select one or more quality performance indicators. So those are three prime areas that we do have to spend a little focus time on. The next slide in your deck provides an illustration of

[03:13:22] the establishment of a reserve fund. And in looking at this work, one of the premises that we anchored on was how could we establish a reserve fund and not reduce funding to local school divisions. So in approaching this, we looked at what has the increase in funding in the act

[03:13:59] been to the state over the last eight years. We took that percentage factor, which ranged between 4% to 5% each year and use that as a calculation in establishing a reserve fund.

[03:14:20] So the chart you're looking at there shows how those dollars would flow if in this next year we had a 2% establishment of the local formula funds, the following year a 3% followed by a 4%, which would then level off. And then on the next slide, you have a scenario that shows

[03:14:57] the increase in funding that would take place to, in this case, five or six school divisions. So we've been very careful in looking at if a reserve fund would be established, could it be done without school divisions receiving less funding than they have received in prior years?

[03:15:26] So that's really key in those two slides. In this next area of program quality indicators, the act requires that the state select at least one of three quality indicators.

[03:15:52] And those are recognized post-secondary credentials, post-secondary credit, and or work-based learning. The state has substantial data to support recognized post-secondary credentials.

[03:16:15] Every school division utilizes them. They are reported, and on 2S3 technical skills attainment that we report to you each year in the annual report, we have successfully surpassed that annually.

[03:16:33] We feel very comfortable with that measure. Backing up to the stakeholders meeting that was held on September the 23rd, there was encouragement in that meeting.

[03:16:50] that we also look at work-based learning. That if work-based learning is now a core part of the profile level Virginia graduate and threaded throughout our standards, that we should also consider that as

a measure.

[03:17:14] So we do present to you for your consideration both recognized post-secondary credential and work-based learning as two probable measures to consider.

[03:17:30] And then finally, the last major piece is that the Act allows the state to set its own performance levels in this first year of the Act.

[03:17:48] We have spent considerable time in discussion with Shelley Loving Ryder, who is here, in looking at these measures.

[03:18:05] And what we are presenting here are the last approved measures by USD. We opted to not want to lower the standard, but to use a standard that had been previously negotiated with USDE.

[03:18:33] You will recall that in the annual report that comes to you annually, that these were the last measures that you approved at that time. We would point out that there is one additional element here that the act included, and that is science.

[03:18:59] We're heretofore, we only reported English reading and mathematics. We will now have to, in the Perkins Act, report on science. And we're working with Shelley's team in terms of being able to provide that data.

[03:19:20] suggestion was that we set that measure at the same level that mathematics and reading was set, which was 85. Those are the major points that are really significant in terms of elements of the application that must go forward in the weola act portal by april the 1st and in the usde portal by no later

[03:19:59] than april the 15th um george do you want to go into the spending plan when that will be done yeah that would be helpful actually so so that right now the board is essentially adopting the percentages of of how we will give it money when you and i met you talked about that there would be another opportunity subsequent to that where we will detail how the spending is done.

[03:20:25] Yes. If the board approves the establishment of the reserve fund, we will then have to develop a plan on how those dollars are used. They must be used to continue to support the original intent of the local formula money which is 132 school divisions and the 23 colleges

[03:21:03] one expenditure that as an example that might be included the omega system and i'm sure around your table there's been discussion over time about omega that system supports federal programs

[03:21:29] and one use of those funds could be to support the CTE share of replacing that system along with the other federal programs that utilize it because it has a direct impact on everyone that utilizes federal funds. It would certainly pass the rigor of the next USD monitoring visit.

[03:22:03] there's also been discussion around how might these funds be used in terms of professional development uh around um workplace place place readiness uh there's a lot of efforts now in terms of work-based coordinators work-based learning coordinators are there things that we could do in that regard that would help the system from secondary to post-secondary.

[03:22:39] So based on the decisions of this board will really drive the work that we do in terms of plans for the actual expenditure of those funds. And we will certainly look to Dr. Lane for leadership in that regard. We do know that the governor's office has called to our attention

[03:23:11] that the ability to establish a reserve fund was there. So we are doing our due diligence in terms of presenting that to you to decide.

[03:23:29] Ms. Hulton. Ms. Hulton. Thank you, George, for that great work and particularly for developing the proposal to create a reserve fund. I think it's an exciting thing. And if I understand correctly, the congressional intent of that reserve fund is really to allow us to do things that would foster innovation in CTE, like our new emphasis on career exploration and work-based learning here in virginia exactly exactly so my only question is can we is there a way we can do it a little more aggressively

[03:24:05] i i because i think we're doing enough here in virginia we we have so much need here in virginia to realign resources to support we've given the divisions a lot of new mandate and expectations around work-based learning and career exploration, but without a whole lot of financial support to do it. And I just feel like we have the opportunity to do things like, as you suggest, professional development in a systemic statewide way that could be an efficient use of these funds to help

[03:24:42] further those goals that I would love to see creating the reserve fund even more robustly earlier on i do like i think you are correct in working on the premise that we don't want to cut funds to divisions for their um current cte programs they're doing amazing stuff with it we as we heard this morning we hear regularly that well high schools as a whole have an engagement problem cte high school students do not have an engagement problem and you all are just the

[03:25:19] the forefront of doing such great work there. I don't want to cut funds to them. I'm not so sure that the money to the community colleges, I'm sure it's important, but frankly, the difference between an 85% and a 90% is potentially just such a drop in the bucket in their budgets that it just may, it may not be that big an impact. I don't want to propose to cut anything from their side other things without inviting input from the community college world and I know you all did

[03:25:55] do that at some point in the process but and we don't have them here today so I don't mean to we do okay good good so so my message to the community colleges I would love to it looks to me like the 90% versus the 95 I mean I'm sorry the 85% versus 90% allocation would allow you to shift a million or so dollars from the VCCS to the school divisions would that then allow you without cutting the school divisions to increase the reserve

[03:26:34] fund more quickly and more robustly and recognizing that that would have an impact on VCCS and we would want to hear that before we made a decision and obviously we're not voting on anything today so there will be opportunity to hear that but I'd love to hear your thoughts on is that a way to increase the reserve fund more robustly I think we got a lot of things we can do with it I'm eager for that conversation about what we're gonna do with it but can we boost it up higher to have more to work with sooner within the authority of the board that is an option that you have we will certainly work with the community

[03:27:13] college system to bring back to you some hard data and numbers pertaining to those dollars at the post-secondary level and how any adjustment between 85 and 90 would look.

[03:27:34] And I'm just looking to them because I don't want to cut the school divisions and I don't know what else, you know, the pot, there aren't any other pieces to look to. So, and I think the other thing that would be helpful is even though we won't be doing the spending, I understand there's going to be a separate plan about how to spend those funds, even though we may not be ready to get to that yet, I would

love to hear when we come back some of your ideas about what could we do to support work-based learning and career exploration more vigorously if we had more money. You know, What would be some brainstorm ideas of what to do with that reserve fund?

[03:28:13] And so that you don't wait two months. Our initial plan and really the target of the money ending up at about 1.1, 1.2 million over time was that should the standard quality recommendation the board's made around work-based learning coordinators not be funded with state funds, we would likely look at using those funds for that purpose.

[03:28:31] But if the General Assembly does fund that, what else would we do? So that's why March is a good time. What more could we do? I can imagine about 50,000 things just sitting right here, but I would love to hear some three or four top priorities.

[03:28:46] What more could you do if you had more funds more quickly in that reserve fund? - Right, and certainly if the General Assembly does provide funding, we will absolutely do that. Should there not be any new funding provided and it's not in the governor's budget, we'll likely be focused on that work. - I hear you, but for instance, could you do that and some enhancement to the support professional development around the career exploration classes in middle school, or what?

[03:29:17] - We will certainly bring back-- - Could you do both and, you know, if there was more money there sooner? - We will certainly bring back recommendations and options. - Dr. Paxton. - Did I hear you say correctly that you initially determined the 4% for the reserve fund based on the last eight years, looking at the history, that on average the increase every year in the grant funding was about 4% to 5%.

[03:29:47] Is that the numbers you put out? Right, in terms of the flat amount of increase in the overall federal grant to the state. It was about-- you said 4% to 5%. Yes, yes. Because I noticed, doing the math, that the projections here basically are projecting a flat five percent. We were optimistic in these numbers here, saying if it was a five percent increase every year, four percent would go to the reserve, and then that provides an additional one percent increase going to both secondary and 85 percent of that going to

[03:30:24] secondary, 15 percent, right? That's what this is suggesting, and so it's very, I won't say aggressive but it would have to work I mean that you'd have to get the 5% for this to work and I guess I'm just getting about clarification on that and also clarification on the fact that they would still get more money every you know the reserve fund would be funded but then still more money would also be going to the secondary schools and the post-secondary schools right the the only time that there's been a hiccups in this theory is in years in which there

[03:31:01] has been sequestration at the federal level. Other than that, we have clear data in terms of that incremental increase that has come in the federal grant.

[03:31:19] So if it's closer to the 4% on average, we would still do this same approach. We just wouldn't put 4% in the reserve to propose a different allocation to like a 3% or something like that, just to ensure that the schools still did get some level of increase.

[03:31:36] Right. We're not... Dr. Pexton, that's one of the reasons we were partly going 2, 3, 4, 4 to give it time to grow into that, so that even if one year it came back at 3 percent, they're already ahead of where they were at the beginning of the plan. Okay.

[03:31:54] Yeah. Dr. Wilson. Mr. Cox, thank you very much for the presentation. I want to make sure I understand this slide that we're looking at right here. In the comments, I noticed there was some concern expressed about the inclusion of science attainment as one of the performance indicators.

[03:32:11] But do I understand this slide to be those items that have already been determined for us? We don't have a choice. This is a question. Do we have a choice as to whether or not science is now included as part of the performance indicators, the core indicators in this list?

[03:32:28] right science is a part of the federal act we do not have an opt that way yes yes thank you thank you dr man thank you i also have one quick question on this slide i wondered if you could uh help me understand what the program placement transition rate measures i did it's right after science actually i just wanted to understand is what that what that is measured right the program

[03:33:00] placement rate transition is actually a measure that looks at student success after graduation from high school. We work with the Weldon Cooperance Center at the University of Virginia to survey students one year after graduation. So that means those students are actually in a work situation. They are either full-time work

[03:33:33] uh college military that's right thank you thank you okay go ahead dr pexton is so we talked a lot about the funding components of this the actual content within item k as far as for example when we talk about the 17 career clusters and the programs of studies that that's all prescribed through perkins or at what point do we influence that that curriculum um or do we absolutely the

[03:34:11] doing uh i guess it was governor warner uh doing his term um enacted that at least every five years every cte course would be reviewed so there is ongoing work at the cte resource center in which i believe this year we have 90 98 courses that are either being reviewed revised developed

[03:34:44] deleted uh you mentioned the 17th cluster as an example general assembly approved that last year we are now uh actually today one of the curriculum development meetings is taking place with experts from the energy sector uh we will also welcome members of of this body at any time uh to come in and join uh observe those teams uh and give input if you saw fit yeah i'm looking for when that

[03:35:22] window of time is to for example when i see school divisions are required to develop at least one new program of study each year or revised existing program to your point i'm just looking for when that window of time is to make sure that uh for example what i what i don't see here in the programs of studies is anything specifically related to the maritime industry and we know that virginia is is the maritime epicenter for the country beyond shipbuilding you know with the wind industry coming in our direction the work that's being done on the hampton roads tunnels and things like that that's a unique skill set quite different from the traditional electrician

[03:35:59] is the marine electrician or from a traditional pipe plumber it's the marine pipe fitter and and so i for example our community college partners they they do have you know maritime technologies or maritime specific programs but we don't see that maritime specific application or programs of studies in high schools and so i'm just looking for that window of time when to introduce that that conversation into the mix because i studies you know there's been economic reports done over the years that do skills analysis uh what's the gap what are we missing

[03:36:33] and quite often in recent years even those very you know respected reports have missed the boat on assessing maritime skills for for virginia because nowhere else in the country do we we produce

or support the economic commerce around the maritime industry than here and so i just would look for when that window of time is i don't know that it's now but um we have a couple i would welcome the opportunity to come sit in an off the line curriculum session to make sure that's part of the conversation a couple of points david and then i'll follow up i would i

[03:37:12] I would like to add that the curriculum, even though we just identified with the time period that we have 98 different courses that are up for review this year, our programs are never stagnant.

[03:37:27] The content in the curriculum is constantly being reviewed. One significant change in Perkins 5 is the addition, and we identified it in an earlier slide of the significant changes is the identification and addition of the comprehensive local needs assessment. That really does drive local decisions and relates those decisions to labor market data.

[03:37:54] It really drives each school division to bring stakeholders together, and there's a requirement of who needs to be part of that process. But closely looking at that labor market data and aligning every line item in their budget related to that comprehensive needs assessment.

[03:38:13] So there is the opportunity at any time for school divisions to be looking at their needs. Now, we also identify that it could be to school divisions benefit to work regionally. They don't have to develop that comprehensive local needs assessment individually.

[03:38:29] They could come together. And in that particular case, in that region, that industry sector could come together with multiple school divisions in the idea of building out maybe an existing pathway and an existing maybe in the in the stem related career cluster but building out an additional pathway so those those types of excuse me opportunities uh do exist at any time and now particularly with this comprehensive local needs assessment i i certainly have an appreciation for that because You know, that's absolutely necessary to make sure that you're getting a good pulse on what the needs are.

[03:39:06] I would just submit that we have recognized, we being Newport News Shipbuilding and several regional initiatives that are going on in that area, have realized that the labor market data has at times fallen short. So I'd be cautious against making sure that the tide is turning.

[03:39:23] They're recognizing that new reports are being made. I would just be cautious in making sure that we are intent about reaching out beyond the labor market data. Of course, we're going to have industry stakeholders, but regional approach would certainly capture the needs of the work of the industry, for sure.

[03:39:39] So I just wanted to emphasize that. Well, Dave, maybe a follow-up question to Dr. Pexton. How might the board suggest an 18th career cluster just around the maritime industry? You know, like Senator Newman proposed with his bill last year on the energy industry, Energy was covered in other areas.

[03:39:58] We pulled it out specifically. You know, essentially what we're saying now is the maritime industry is probably covered under logistics in a couple different places. How might we, how, if the board were interested in an 18th career cluster, how would they go about that? Clearly, the workforce needs have to be identified.

[03:40:17] We wouldn't want to go in the direction of creating something and the workforce needs were not there. I think that's the beginning phase of where to look at that aspect. One of the things that we did

in approaching the 17 cluster energy was charge the Weldon Cooper Center to initially do a research study to determine what the economic needs were around energy across the state.

[03:40:49] If it be Dr. Lane's decision, we could certainly ask the Weldon Cooper Center to produce for us an economic development study around the maritime industry and provide that information back.

[03:41:10] It would certainly aid our staff as well in terms of our short and long-term work. I think that would be appropriately timely when you consider some of the significant developments that's happened even in the past year in that industry. Newport New Shipbuilding has 32, just was recently awarded $32 billion worth of backlog work with the Navy for the next 20 years.

[03:41:34] That's a huge indicator for the economy. You know, the wind industry and the developments in that, I think that the timing of that would be very, very relevant. So let's assume this market and labor analysis done by Weldon Cooper suggests that there is a job growth and a job need in the maritime industry.

[03:41:58] How would the board go about creating an 18th career cluster? Or is that my decision? Or does that have to go through the General Assembly? I guess is really what we're asking. It would be a new action if we look how did we reach where we are.

[03:42:15] Virginia adopted the nationally recognized 16 clusters. So that is how the 16 clusters spread across Virginia. On the previous gubernatorial leadership, the 16 clusters were accepted.

[03:42:34] They have been infused into every curriculum content area. Every course has those competencies embedded. the energy industry went to the General Assembly and legislated the development of a 17th cluster.

[03:42:58] Certainly, as we started in the first slide, this board is authorized to carry out the work of career and technical education in Virginia. So if this body determined that it was in the economic development interest of the Commonwealth that there be career and technical and increase in career and technical education programs in the maritime area, because we do have a couple now.

[03:43:36] But if that were to be scaled up to a cluster and then pathways develop out of that, that could be a charge of the board to the Department of Education to carry out over time. Dr. Pex's real question, when is the best time for them to do that?

[03:43:57] It takes time to build that out. And we work at the pleasure of the board. We are working on 98 courses this year. If that were to become a direction of the board, we would stage that into our annual work plan.

[03:44:20] I would like to just add another comment, just using the energy sector as an example. And now the addition of four pathways, additional courses, some revision to some existing courses. But for those four pathways to roll out for the beginning of July of this year, you do have to think about the obvious, too, about staffing those programs.

[03:44:43] There's going to be ramifications with additions. You know, obviously, you know, the numbers are going to come from somewhere. There'll be some movement with programs. But within your existing staffing and those that have a license, for example, teaching technology education, which may be one of the endorsements to teach some of the energy courses, There may be some elimination of other courses that those teachers are certified to teach.

[03:45:07] So there's a lot of variables is what I'm saying. It's not just about building out the energy cluster, for example, like we are right now. It's the ramifications of how it impacts other programs and those labor markets. So it sounds like let's definitely move forward on the labor analysis with Weldon Cooper, bring that back to the board in the next couple of months, and then we'll discuss that later.

[03:45:30] That sounds like. Okay. sure thank you miss atkinson just a question when we did the enter and i know it's been done by statute but did we involve was the advisory board involved in any of that work yes and so that's just as a board that's another avenue is to we have an advisory board that probably has quite a bit of expertise that might assist us with these questions and certainly have them see the labor data first and make a recommendation? Certainly. Okay. Can I ask more mundane

[03:46:07] questions than this one? It looks to me like we have taken the entire reserve fund out of, and I know it's lawful, but out of the local portion of Perkins grant. In other words, the statute seems to say that we have to give a minimum of 85% to the locals. We hit that minimum and then it says we can basically take 15% of that 85 or 12 and three quarter percent and use it at the essentially the state level the other

[03:46:41] two boxes though are the state admin which james would kick me if i suggested we take any of the five percent all right but then there's 10 that goes to this category state leadership what do we do with the state leadership money and is it as well spent as reserve fund money would you know would theoretically be so we know i mean it's hard for me to compare honestly the impact of giving the locals whether it be community college you know or the school divisions us in the form of

[03:47:14] the reserve or us in the form of leadership funds until i have a better understanding of what happens with that money you know how effectively it's used it's not to say i'm suggesting we do that i just need to think about it in order to make a decision about how so you don't have to do it this time, but could we discuss between this meeting and the next one what the use of the leadership funds is?

[03:47:42] Yes. Thank you. And George, secondary question. Are you allowed to pull the reserve out of, you know, there's the first split of 85-15 from state and local. No, you're not. But you could raise the percentage from 85 to a higher number, right? Sure.

[03:47:57] And therefore get to the same mathematical, you know, numerical place. Sure. It would basically be taken away from, we get up to 15% on our side. so if we lower that to our petroleum of 12 and a half you've got two and a half of the hole to play with uh you could use effectively run that to to keep the locals whole yeah and we'll be sure again i'm not that is not a proposal by any means it's not saying i think that's what ought to happen it's saying i really don't know what ought to happen because i just don't have a clue what we do with that money and i probably ought to have a clue sometimes it pays well that's it wouldn't

[03:48:33] that be the admin money? Again, I think there are things we have to do with the leadership funds. We'll prepare for you next month. CTE Resource Center, that money is well spent. I'm not suggesting it's not, by the way. I just want to understand it before we vote on it. Any reduction in state leadership would impact CTE Resource Center, would impact a lot of our partners. That's how state leadership is spent.

[03:48:54] So it would be helpful for me to have the definition as it appears in the act for each of those areas particularly leadership and admin yeah thank you that question should not be misread as anything other than what it was no and we actually actually have sheets in my pad here on each one of those now so

we will be more than pleased to share that all right any other questions on this if not thank you guys so much for the very complete presentation and we'll take this

[03:49:27] on first review oh did you want to ask me to do it no it was just simply going to say to the state superintendent of public instruction fair enough recommends that the board receive for first review the perkins fire plan perfect we are happy to do that all right i think that covers all the action items we have two written reports uh do we want an oral at all on the update on the 2020 assembly or are we content to have the writing we have the writing perfect uh good no questions about that

[03:50:06] discussion of current issues are there any current issues there are dr mann you look like you're okay fair enough i've got just two things one is uh you know our bylaws article nine you know allow me to appoint new committees uh we have pretty much wrapped up the evidence-based committee that helped us through the SOQ work and the building leadership piece in large part.

[03:50:40] It is my belief that we ought to turn our attention to, and I plan to form a committee headed by Dr. Paxton, to work on the third piece of our comprehensive work plan, which is accreditation, the impact, you know, where we think, what we think it's done, what we think the new system will accomplish, and where we ought to be going from here.

[03:51:01] so we'll form that one in march i hope unless i meet with strenuous objection between now and march i've asked dr pexton to do this and to just sort of give me some idea what you would like to see in terms of who's on and who's willing to work on this so some conversation with dr pexton between now and march would be beneficial in that regard the second and this is uh i guess more personal in a sense i don't know if any of you knew jim schrader jamil you might have known jim schrader Jim Schrader was a Chesterfield School Board member for Allotters.

[03:51:33] He was a local dentist who was a lot more than a local dentist. He has started crossover ministries. He was, you know, one of the truly amazing human beings. He passed a great loss for the world. He is somebody who clearly fulfilled the mission of making his corner of the world a much better place.

[03:51:53] So with that, there's no other business to come before the board. We are adjourned.

